Public Acceptance of International Redistribution in High-Income Countries

Abstract

Using an original survey of 12,000 respondents ~~representative of~~ in eleven high-income countries~~(the United States, Japan, Russia, Saudi Arabia, and seven European countries),~~ , I examine public support for international redistribution and climate policies. ~~There is majority acceptance in every countryfor~~ In every country, majorities accept nearly all global policies tested, including ~~those~~ some that would redistribute 5 percent of ~~global income or entail personal costs for respondents. Despite stated acceptance,~~ world income or be personally costly. Yet international redistribution lacks prominence in policymaking and public ~~debates.~~ debate. I solve this ~~prominence–preference~~ preference–prominence puzzle using survey experiments. ~~An information treatment shows that support for global policies causally~~ Support increases among respondents ~~who perceive them~~ induced to perceive global policies as likely, an effect opposite to "warm glow". ~~Rather than insincere or inconsistent attitudes, I show that low~~ Low salience and pluralistic ignorance ~~can~~ reconcile strong acceptance with low prominence. ~~I also test the sensitivity of acceptance to key policy features such as the size of transfers and country coverage. Support for international policies~~ Support decreases only slightly as country coverage shrinks.

JEL codes: H23, Q58, F35, P48, Q54, H77.
Keywords: Redistribution, global policies, cap-and-trade, attitudes, survey, warm glow.

I Introduction

The issue of North-to-South transfers of resources and power permeates negotiations in many areas, including debt restructuring, development assistance, tax cooperation, UN reform, and climate finance.[1] In all international fora, Global South countries seek a more equal world order. ~~Indeed,~~ The stakes are high: redirecting just 1% of high-income countries' output to low-income countries (LICs) would ~~mechanically double their~~ more than double their nominal national income.[2]

Public attitudes in high-income countries (HICs) are key to ~~understanding~~ assessing whether globally redistributive policies would be politically feasible. Recent large-scale surveys reveal worldwide support for a globally coordinated tax on billionaires (Cappelen, Støstad and Tungodden 2025), for a democratic world government for global issues (Ghassim and Pauli 2024), for climate action at the global (rather than national) level (Dechezleprêtre et al. 2025), ~~as well as~~ and for globally redistributive climate or tax policies (Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch 2025).

Despite strong stated acceptance, even in HICs, international redistribution remains limited. This preference–prominence puzzle could ~~be explained by an overstatement of support in previous surveys or by a discrepancy between public attitudes and official policy~~ arise either because previous surveys overstated support or because official policy diverges from public attitudes. In this paper, I solve the puzzle by ~~demonstrating~~ showing how low salience and pluralistic ignorance can reconcile strong acceptance with low prominence.

I conduct a ~~pre-registered~~ large-scale pre-registered survey to examine whether global redistribution policies are robustly accepted and ~~to investigate the reasons for their lack of prominence. I test several hypotheses.~~ why they lack prominence. Surveying eleven HICs, I first test whether international policies are accepted by majorities in countries considered conservative and not yet surveyed on this topic, such as Japan, Poland, Russia, Saudi Arabia, and Switzerland. ~~Recognizing that~~ Since some key countries would likely not participate ~~if these policieswere implemented, I~~ in such policies, I also test how accep-

[1] The (re)distribution of resources between countries is debated in different official fora, such as the G20, the OECD's Base Erosion and Profit Shifting project, the Conference on Financing for Development, the International Maritime Organization, the Global Solidarity Levies Taskforce, the UN Framework Convention on International Tax Cooperation, and the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change. Appendix **??** provides references on official initiatives for global redistribution.

[2] The GDP per capita of high-income countries (HICs) is 28 times greater than that of low-income countries (LICs) at Purchasing Power Parity (PPP) and 68 times greater in nominal terms, from World Bank 2024 data. Given that 625 million people live in one of the 25 low-income countries and 1.42 billion people in high-income countries, 1% of HICs' GDP corresponds to 60% of LICs' GDP using PPP values and 153% using nominal data.

tance ~~is affected~~ changes when a climate scheme or a wealth tax is international ~~but not~~ rather than truly global. I ~~explore three other~~ then explore three mechanisms that could explain the preference–prominence gap. First, I test for pluralistic ignorance. Second, I analyze the salience of global redistribution ~~,~~and whether it is a vote-determining issue. Third, I test for "warm glow", whereby people delude themselves into supporting hypothetical policies ~~in order~~ to ease their conscience~~, notably by testing whether the support is only claimed for~~ ; in particular, I test whether support is expressed only as long as the policies ~~are deemed~~ seem unlikely. Finally, I explore a variety of international policies, ranging from the plausible to the radical.

I find majority acceptance[3] in every country surveyed for almost all globally redistributive policies tested. Policies currently discussed in international negotiations are accepted by large majorities. The most supported policy is the 2% tax on ~~billionaire~~ billionaires' wealth proposed by Zucman (2024), with 81% acceptance in the pooled sample. Proposals such as debt relief for vulnerable countries, developed countries contributing 0.7% of their GDP in foreign aid, an expansion of the UN Security Council, or the Bridgetown ~~initiative (expanding sustainable investments at low interests rates~~ Initiative (expanding low-interest sustainable investment in LICs) all garner at least 70% acceptance overall.

What if a sustainable development policy is international but not global? Acceptance decreases only slightly. ~~In the case of~~ For a wealth tax with 30% of its revenue financing LICs, acceptance ~~is reduced~~ falls from 74% to 68% when the policy is implemented ~~only by~~ by only some countries (e.g., the EU, the UK, and Brazil) rather than by all countries. Likewise, acceptance of an International Climate Scheme (ICS), defined as a cap-and-trade ~~with~~ scheme with an equal per capita allocation of emission~~s~~rights, decreases from 68% to 65% when ~~participating countries shrink from a group~~ the coalition of participating countries shrinks from one covering 72% of world emissions to one covering 33%~~of emissions~~.

Radical proposals are also widely accepted. Majorities in every country agree that "governments should actively cooperate to have all countries converge in terms of GDP per capita by the end of the century", and that globally coordinated climate policies are preferable to the status quo, even if they entail completely electrifying cars by 2045 and doubling the prices of heating fuel, flights, and beef. Overall, ~~I find~~ 64% ~~acceptance for~~ accept a progressive income tax ~~that would~~ on the global top 3% that would collect 5%

[3]Throughout the paper, I ~~make a distinction~~ distinguish between *support* and *acceptance*. I use the term *support* to refer to the absolute share of *Somewhat* or *Strong support* on Likert scales, and *acceptance* to refer to relative support —specifically, the support share among non-*Indifferent* responses.

of world income to finance poverty reduction in the Global South, ~~which would collect 5% of world income from the global top 3%,~~ with marginal tax rates ranging from 15% above $80,000 per year to 45% above $1 million. Relatedly, in an interactive task ~~where~~ in which respondents design their preferred global income redistribution, nearly half choose a redistribution that would make them poorer (versus ~~less~~ fewer than 10% ~~choosing~~ who choose one that would make them richer). The average custom redistribution ~~entails~~ transfers over 5% of world income ~~in transfers~~ from the rich to the poor.

Although stated answers ~~seem to suggest a~~ suggest strong acceptance of international redistribution policies, the strength and consistency of this support can only be confirmed ~~in situations where~~ when respondents are not primed to focus on ~~this issue , and where international redistribution is competing~~ the issue and when international redistribution competes with other desirable goals. ~~To achieve this, I~~ I therefore test the prioritization of this topic ~~using three experiments~~ with three tasks at the start of the survey. Before respondents could infer the survey's topic, they ~~had to complete~~ answered an open-ended ~~field,~~ question, completed a conjoint experiment, and performed a budget allocation task.

When asked to allocate the revenue from a global wealth tax among five spending items, 87% of respondents allocate a positive amount to the global item (public services in LICs). This item receives an average preferred share of 17.5% of the revenue, slightly below an equal split of 20%. This indicates that most people prioritize sustainable development abroad less than the average issue, but still consider it worthwhile.

While policies to address global inequality are widely accepted, they have low salience~~.~~ ~~Indeed, this~~ : the topic is rarely mentioned in the open-ended ~~fields~~ questions at the beginning of the survey, ~~where respondents were asked to~~ in which respondents write about various considerations. Respondents' top concern is the cost of living, and their most frequent wish is for greater purchasing power. ~~While inequality is most often regarded~~ Although inequality is the answer most often given as the greatest injustice ~~—with some~~ (with inconclusive indications that these ~~responses relate~~ answers refer to inequality at the global ~~level—~~ level), global inequality almost never appears among the issues respondents consider important but neglected in public debate. The low priority placed on global redistribution may explain why it is seldom discussed in public debates, despite widespread acceptance of related policies.

Despite its low salience, global redistribution may be a vote-determining issue for some people, as the conjoint experiment suggests. In this task, respondents ~~express their preference~~ choose between two political programs, each composed of policies randomly ~~selected~~ drawn from those prominently debated in their country. When a program includes a *global tax on millionaires with 30% of the revenue funding LICs*, the ~~likelihood of~~

that program being probability that it is preferred increases by 5 percentage points (p.p.), while *cutting development aid* reduces it by 3 p.p. A direct question confirms that some voters might change their vote intention if a candidate campaigned on sustainable development: 36% of respondents report they would be more likely (versus 17% less likely) to vote for a party if it participated in a global movement for climate action, taxes on millionaires, and poverty reduction in LICs. In a related question, 68% of respondents (and 52% of the 561 millionaires[4] who responded) state they could actively participate in such a movement (either by signing a petition, attending a demonstration, going on strike, or donating to a strike fund).

Although low salience contributes to the lack of prominence of international redistribution, it cannot fully explain why related proposals are so rarely put forward by nonprofit organizations or electoral candidates, especially given the apparent electoral potential. I test two hypotheses that could help explain this puzzle: pluralistic ignorance and unreliable support. I find evidence only for the former.

I identify pluralistic ignorance through an incentivized question that asks respondents for their belief regarding to estimate support for the Global (version of the) Climate Scheme (GCS), either among their compatriots or in the U.S. In Japan and in European countries, there is majority support for a majority supports the GCS, yet most people believe there is it does not. Overall, the median respondent underestimates support in their own country by 16 p.p. and non-American respondents underestimate support in the U.S. by 22 p.p. Pluralistic ignorance may be an important reason why global solidarity solutions are neglected.

To test whether support might drop if the prospect of global policies materializes (a form of *warm glow*), I manipulate the belief that large international transfers are likely in the next fifteen years. More specificallySpecifically, I inform a random half of the respondents that "countries have agreed to demonstrate some degree of solidarity in addressing global challenges" , providing diverse examplesand provide diverse examples, including the adoption of a shipping levy at the International Maritime Organization that should partly finance LICs, developed countries' commitments to finance climate action in developing countries, and the G20's study by the G20 of a coordinated tax on billionaires. The information treatment increases the belief that transfers are likely by 7 p.p. from a baseline of 33%, and it also *increases* the share of global policies supported by 1 p.p. An IV estimation shows that believing international transfers are likely causally increases the share of policies supported causally increases by 18 p.p.when people believe that international

[4] Millionaire A millionaire is understood defined as having someone with a net wealth of at least one million dollar dollars, or the equivalent in other currencies , cf. (see Question **??**).

~~transfers are likely~~, consistent with the non-causal ~~effect estimated by OLS~~ OLS estimate. In other words, I find no evidence of *warm glow*. On the contrary, the effect goes in the ~~opposite direction compared~~ direction opposite to the *warm glow* hypothesis: ~~if people believed~~ people who believe that a global policy ~~were likely , they would be~~ is likely are more likely to support it (which can be interpreted as a *status quo* bias).

Finally, I ~~test~~ examine respondents' broad values to ~~verify~~ check their consistency with global redistribution. ~~The~~ A majority of respondents agree that "helping countries in need is the right thing to do". However, only a minority ~~is convinced that it~~ believes that doing so is in HICs' long-term interest ~~to do so,~~ or that it is their historical responsibility. Similarly, there is no majority support for reparations for colonization and slavery in the pooled sample. These results suggest that support for global solidarity is driven by a sense of empathy and duty rather than by guilt or interest.

Universalism has been identified as one of the best predictors of voting behavior (Enke 2020) and ideology (Cappelen, Enke and Tungodden 2025; Enke, Rodríguez-Padilla and Zimmermann 2023), particularly in Western countries (Cappelen, Enke and Tungodden 2025). I ~~use~~ measure universalism with a new question ~~to measure universalism, asking~~ that asks respondents which group they advocate for when they vote. Overall, 45% choose a universalist response (either "Humans" or "Sentient beings (humans and animals)"), while 32% opt for their fellow citizens. Using a variance decomposition, I find that universalism is a stronger predictor of policy attitudes than sociodemographic variables such as income, country, or even vote choice, echoing the results of Enke, Rodríguez-Padilla and Zimmermann (2023). ~~Besides, there is a majority of universalists~~ Universalists form a majority in Europe, in Saudi Arabia, and among left-wing voters.

This observation aligns with the cross-national differences observed in synthetic indicators: Saudi Arabia, Italy, and Spain exhibit the highest levels of support for global redistribution, while Japan, Switzerland, the U.S., and Poland show the lowest.

Related literature. There are few cross-country surveys on international policies. They consistently find strong public support for globally redistributive policies (Cappelen, Støstad and Tungodden 2025; Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch 2025) or global democratic governance (Ghassim and Pauli 2024). Relative to Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch (2025), who surveyed the U.S. and four Western European countries on a Global Climate Scheme and a global tax on millionaires, this paper extends the evidence to more conservative countries, tests whether support persists when country coverage is partial, measures the priority given to global redistribution before respondents know the survey topic (through a conjoint experiment that includes an anti-aid policy and a budget allocation among

several spending items), and directly tests for warm glow. It also examines a broader range of policies, from those currently under international negotiation to transfers of 5% of world income.

The first questions on respondents' considerations contribute to an extensive ~~literature in political science~~ political science literature on "issue salience"~~—the~~, the priority attributed to a given issue. Issue salience is ~~now~~ widely acknowledged as a key ~~factor in determining~~ determinant of voting behavior (Dennison 2019; Edwards, Mitchell and Welch 1995; Egan 2013; Krosnick 1988; RePass 1971). Furthermore, ~~according to~~ open-ended responses ~~,~~ show that the "most important issues" relate to the economy and healthcare (Wlezien 2005). Although climate change and hunger appear in the top five problems when the question is framed at the global rather than national level (Yeager et al. 2011), public acceptance of sustainable development policies may be overshadowed by more pressing concerns in voters' choices. Meanwhile, 40% of Norwegian respondents cite the international distribution of costs in an open-ended question about climate change injustice, by far the most cited category (Gregersen, Helliesen and Jagers 2025).

The finding of pluralistic ignorance echoes similar ~~findings documented~~ evidence regarding climate action (Andre et al. 2024*a*,*b*; Mildenberger and Tingley 2019), the billionaire tax (Cappelen, Støstad and Tungodden 2025), and the GCS (Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch 2025).

Although this paper focuses on multilateral policies, it relates to the literature on attitudes toward foreign aid. Kaufmann, McGuirk and Vicente (2019) and Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch (2025) find that, despite substantial overestimation of aid amounts, desired aid exceeds perceived aid in most countries. Hudson and van Heerde (2012) provide a critical review of the literature and show that the strong support for poverty alleviation largely stems from intrinsic altruism, in line with Eurobarometer data (Cho 2024).

Nair (2018) finds that Americans underestimate their rank in the global income distribution by 27 percentiles on average and overestimate the global median income by a factor of 10, which lowers their support for foreign aid. ~~Similarly~~Relatedly, Fehr, Mollerstrom and Perez-Truglia (2022) find that 9 out of 10 Germans ~~express support for~~ support global redistribution, even though ~~respondents~~ they underestimate their position in the global income distribution by an average of 15 percentiles.

Finally, the paper contributes to the literature ~~analyzing dispositions towards free-riding on~~ on free riding in climate action and ~~the ways in which~~ on how support for climate agreements depends on their country coverage. Using conjoint analyses in Western countries, Beiser-McGrath and Bernauer (2019*b*) ~~demonstrate~~ show that climate agreements with broader country coverage are more likely to be preferred. In Germany and the U.S.,

Gampfer, Bernauer and Kachi (2014) also find stronger support for funding climate action in low-income countries when the cost is shared with other countries. Nevertheless, surveys consistently show that people support ~~their country taking~~ unilateral climate action ~~, even in the absence of such action in other countries~~ by their country, even when other countries do not act (Beiser-McGrath and Bernauer 2019*a*; Bernauer and Gampfer 2015; McGrath and Bernauer 2017). Aklin and Mildenberger (2020) show that the empirical evidence for ~~free-riding~~ free riding is not compelling, and that climate inaction can be equally well explained by distributive conflicts. Still, survey evidence indicates some degree of conditional cooperation: support for domestic climate action increases if other countries join forces (Carlsson et al. 2025; Tam et al. 2025).

II Data and Design

Samples. I conducted an original survey of 12,001 respondents representative of the adult population in eleven high-income countries (see Figure 1). The countries were chosen to span the diversity of high-income countries and the sample sizes to be commensurate with each country's population size.[5] The survey was fielded online in 2025 ~~using the~~ by the survey companies *Yandex* (for Russia), *Kantar* (for Saudi Arabia), and *Bilendi* (for the other countries).[6]

In Russia, I could not administer the same questionnaire as in the other countries.[7] I had to curtail it for two reasons. First, ~~I could not use the platform *Qualtrics*, which prevented me from using~~ *Qualtrics* could not be used, which ruled out certain question formats (such as constant sum scales) ~~or embedding Javascript (used to design~~ and embedded JavaScript (used for the interactive question). Second, ~~I had to cut or reword some questions~~ some questions had to be cut or reworded due to preventive censorship by the survey company. In the other countries, the questionnaires are almost identical, although the figures in the questions are adapted to the country-specific context (e.g., respondents are informed about the cost of the Global Climate Scheme to the average

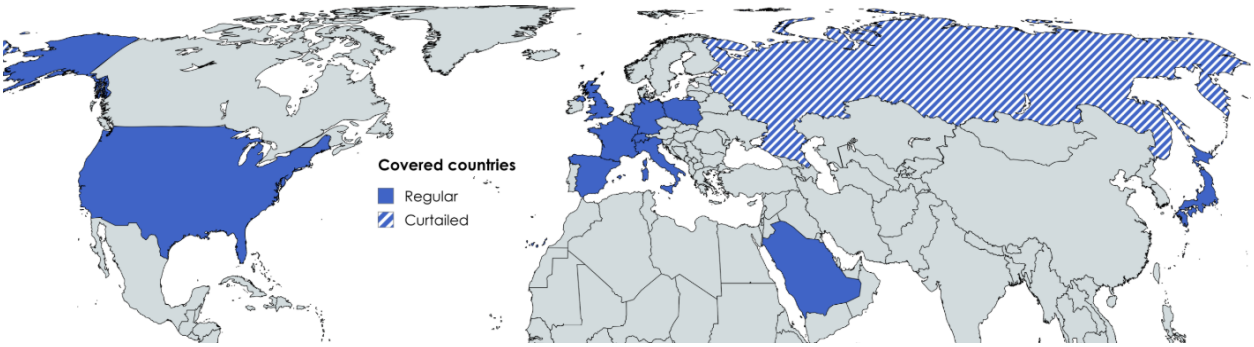
[5]The sample sizes are as follows: U.S.: 3,000; Japan: 2,000; Russia: 1,001; Saudi Arabia: 1,000; Europe: 5,000, split in proportion to the countries' adult population sizes (except for Switzerland), i.e., France: 798; Germany: 1,048; Italy: 756; Spain: 603; UK: 826; Poland: 500; Switzerland: 469. The maximum margins of error (at the 95 % ~~threshold~~confidence level) for country samples range from ±1.8 p.p. in the U.S. to ±4.5 p.p. in Switzerland, with an intermediate value of ±3.1 p.p. in Saudi Arabia.

[6]For all countries except Russia, responses were collected between April 15 and July 3, 2025. For Russia, responses were collected between September 19 and October 9, 2025. Each complete response was rewarded with approximately €3 in gift points.

[7]To the best of my knowledge, Toews and Suvorov (2025) were the first to manage surveying the Russian public on climate attitudes.

person in their country).[8]

Figure 1: Country coverage of the survey.



Representativeness. The samples are stratified using quotas to be representative of ~~the~~ each country's adult population ~~based on the following quota~~ along the following variables (with some exceptions[9]): gender, age (5 brackets), income (4), ~~diploma~~ education (3), region (2 to 5), and urbanicity (2 to 3). The samples closely match the actual population frequencies along these dimensions, except for Russia and Saudi Arabia, where individuals without a high school diploma are somewhat underrepresented, as ~~well as~~ are low-income individuals in Russia and non-Saudis in Saudi Arabia (see Tables **??**-**??** in Appendix **??**). All results are reweighted to be fully representative of the population along the quotas, with weights trimmed between 0.25 and 4. Results aggregated at the global or European ~~levels weigh~~ level weight each country in proportion to its adult population size. Descriptive results on a random branch use weights that are recomputed within that subsample.

Sociodemographic variables explain 10% to 15% of the variance in the main attitudinal outcomes, and this figure drops to 5% after accounting for country and vote (Figure **??**). In other words, although variables such as age and ~~diploma~~ education are significantly correlated with attitudes (see Tables **??**-**??**), differences in average acceptance of a policy between (say) age groups rarely exceed a dozen percentage points. In contrast, ~~our~~ my measure of universalism is a stronger predictor than any sociodemographic variable.

~~While support~~ Support for the main attitudinal outcomes is highest among left-wing voters and lowest among far-right voters, while non-voters ~~exhibit~~ hold attitudes close to the center of the political spectrum (Appendix **??**). ~~Besides, attitudes~~ Attitudes are much less polarized in Japan ~~compared to~~ than in Europe and the U.S. Figure **??** shows how

[8] Appendix **??** lists the unique features of the questionnaire in each country.

[9] In the U.S., I also use race (4 categories) as a quota variable. In Saudi Arabia, I do not use urbanicity, but I use citizenship (Saudi vs. non-Saudi). In Russia, I do not use region nor urbanicity.

the weighted samples compare to actual voting results in the most recent election. Although the ~~proportion~~ share of self-reported non-voters is lower than ~~in reality~~the actual share, voting patterns across the three main political leanings are similar to the actual distribution. Additionally, the main results are robust to reweighting by vote (Appendix **??**).

Data Quality. The median survey duration is 17 minutes (13 min in Russia). ~~Best practices have been implemented to ensure top-notch~~ I followed best practices to ensure high data quality (Stantcheva 2023). The questionnaire was carefully worded in a neutral and informative way;[10] tested on random people in public spaces to ensure correct comprehension; translated by professional translators, with figures converted into national currencies; and double-checked by native speakers.

Of all respondents who were allowed to continue (as their quotas were not full), 17% dropped out (including 10% who dropped out after the socio-demographic questions). The final sample ~~is obtained after excluding~~ excludes 16% of ~~respondents from~~ the extended sample for ~~suspicion of~~ suspected low quality: 9% for failing an attention test and 13% for completing the questionnaire in less than 6 minutes[11] (including 5% for both reasons). I check for differential attrition and finds~~s~~no correlation of treatment arms with attrition (Appendix **??**). I also show that the main results replicate in the extended sample (Appendix **??**).

The order of ~~question~~ response items is randomized whenever possible. Item order generally has a significant but small effect on answers (2 to 14 p.p.), as shown in Appendix **??**. The size of this effect helps identify questions for which opinions are strongly held (e.g., a preference for a sustainable scenario over the status quo) versus weakly held (e.g., the preferred amount of climate finance).

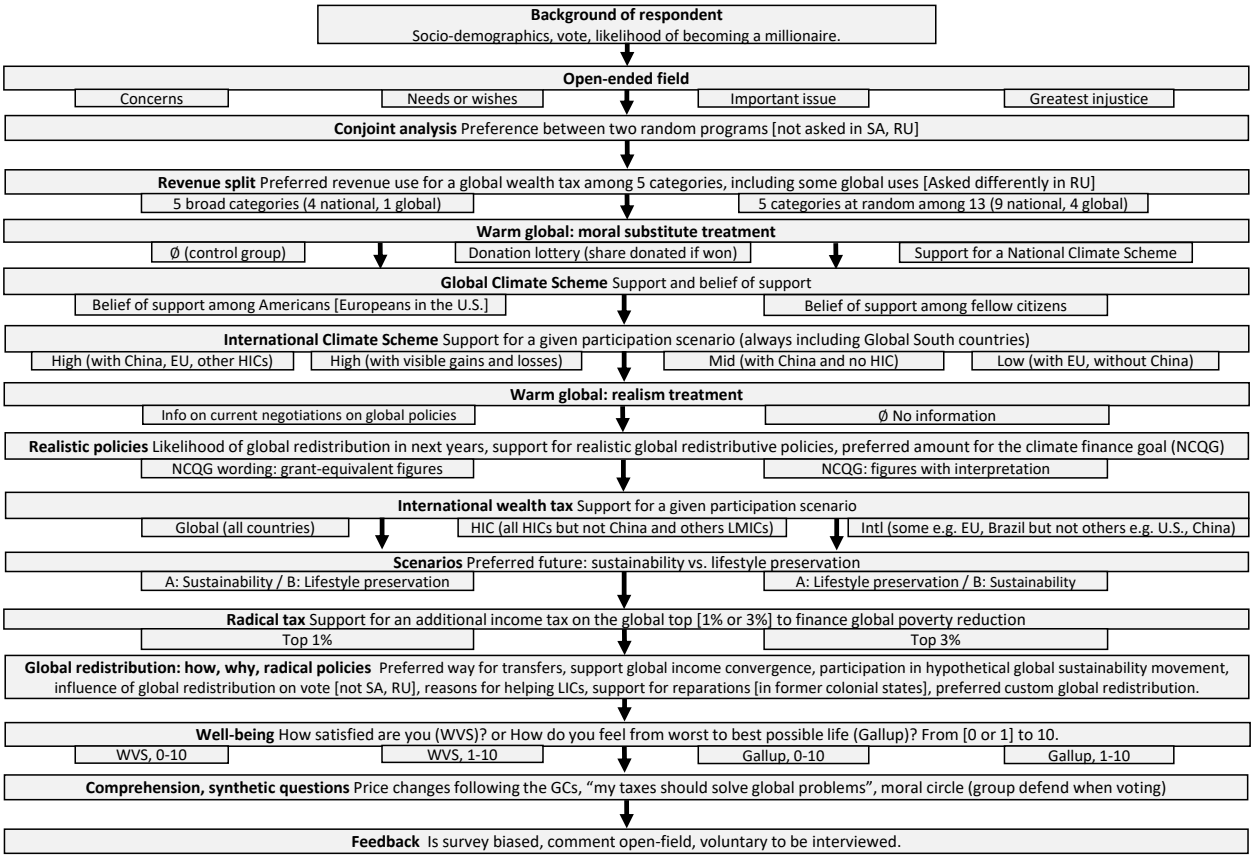
Incentives. The questionnaire includes three incentivized questions, each awarding a $100 prize to one randomly selected winner. First, a comprehension question about the Global Climate Scheme (GCS) checks whether respondents understand the policy's cost. Second, a donation lottery allows respondents to choose what portion of the prize they would donate to a reforestation NGO, should they win. Third, a question assesses respondents' perception of the actual support for the GCS, rewarding a correct guess.

[10] At the end of the survey, 70% of the respondents find the survey politically unbiased (Figure **??**). The most common comment left by respondents in the feedback field is that the survey was "interesting"; very few criticize it (Figure **??**).

[11] 6 minutes corresponds to 30% of the expected median duration of 20 min. In Russia, the cutoff is 200 seconds, or 30% of the expected median duration of 11 minutes.

Survey Structure. ~~While~~ Appendix **??** provides the full questionnaire, and Figure 2 depicts the survey flow with all random branches. ~~The various treatments are independent and uniformlydistributed. Whenever there is a~~ Treatments are assigned independently and uniformly. Whenever a question follows a treatment, the ~~acceptance rates reported are computed using~~ reported acceptance rates are computed on the control group. Appendix **??** runs placebo tests to check if earlier treatments affect unrelated outcomes.

Figure 2: Survey flow.



After collecting sociodemographic characteristics, the questionnaire begins with broad questions to assess the prioritization and salience of global solidarity before respondents become aware of the survey topic. First, respondents answer one open-ended ~~fields~~ question, on either their main concerns, ~~wants, issues~~ their wishes, an issue of interest, or perceived injustices. Second, they complete a conjoint experiment ~~where they have to~~ in which they select their preferred political program ~~,~~ or abstain. Both programs are randomly generated: ~~each policy (or lack thereof) in five policy domains is selected~~ in each of five policy domains, a policy (or its absence) is drawn at random from a pool of policies that are prominent in the country's public debate. Third, respondents allocate the revenue of a global wealth tax among five (national or global) spending items.

Then follow attitudinal questions about the main policies studied: a *Climate Scheme* at the national, global, or international level; an international wealth tax funding low-income countries; and ten plausible global solidarity policies. These questions include treatments that vary the international coverage of policies or test for warm glow.

The final part of the questionnaire explores attitudes towards more radical global redistribution scenarios and includes more sophisticated questions, such as an interactive task in which respondents can choose their preferred custom redistribution of global incomes by manipulating sliders.

The survey concludes with a comprehension question, synthetic questions (e.g., regarding one's moral circle), and a feedback field.

Pre-registered Hypotheses and Data Availability. The project ~~has been approved by the CIRED~~ was approved by an institutional review board ~~(IRB-CIRED-2025-2) and preregistered~~ and pre-registered in the Open Science ~~Foundation registry (osf.io/7mzn4~~Framework registry (identifying details withheld for anonymized review). The study did not deviate from the registration; the questionnaires and ~~hypotheses~~ hypothesis tests used are ~~the ones specified *ex ante*~~those specified *ex ante*. All data, code, and figures from the paper ~~are available at github.com/bixiou/robustness_global_redistr~~will be made publicly available.

III Salience and Prioritization of Global Solidarity

In this section, I analyze the salience of global solidarity in undirected open-ended fields, and the prioritization of global programs in a budget allocation task.

III.A Top-of-mind Considerations

At the beginning of the survey, respondents are randomly assigned one of four open-ended questions: their main concerns, their needs or wishes, an issue important to them but neglected in public debate, or the greatest injustice of all. The questions are deliberately broad and vague to let respondents express their top-of-mind considerations without any priming.

To analyze the answers, I automatically translated each ~~field~~ answer into English.[12] Then, I used AI and my own reading of a few hundred answers to identify the most common concepts, from which I selected 27 categories. Next, I classified each answer into one or more of these categories, both manually (Figures **??-??**) and automatically using AI

[12] I used onlinedoctranslator.com, which is powered by *Google Translate*.

(Figure **??**). Finally, I manually defined a list of 47 (disjunctions of) keywords and used it to automatically classify all responses.[13] Figure **??** reports the 24 most common keyword matches.

The three different classification methods yield consistent results but differ in accuracy. While the keyword classification allows for an exact and reproducible search, the AI search is not limited to specific words and captures more matching responses. Overall, manual classification seems to provide the most accurate results, with a number of matches generally falling between those of the other two methods. For example, ~~to~~ for the *injustice* question, 1.2% of answers match the keywords for *global inequality* and ChatGPT identifies this category in 7.5% of answers, versus 3.2% according to my manual coding.[14] Indeed, the AI incorrectly classifies unspecific answers like "poverty" in this category,[15] while the keyword search misses answers like "inequality among humans". Given this observation, I use the manual classification as the benchmark and the two other methods as robustness checks.

While less accurate than the classifications, word clouds (Figure 3) provide a simple visualization of the most common concepts in each question. By far, the most frequent *concerns* or *wishes* of respondents relate to their purchasing power, with concepts such as "money", "inflation", the "cost of living", or "financial stability" appearing in 31% of these ~~fields~~answers. Within countries, the share of people concerned with money decreases with income: it ranges from 22% in the top income decile to 35% in the bottom one.[16] The next most frequent *concerns* are health (or the healthcare system, 13%), far-right governments (or related concepts such as "Trump" or "trade tariffs", 10%) and war (either in general or specific conflicts, such as the Gaza War, 9%). Most *wishes* are personal, with the next most frequent (after money) relating to one's own or one's relatives' health (21%) or peace of mind (10%). Interestingly, almost none of the responses mention relational considerations, such as love, friendships, loneliness, intimate life, or the desire to have children (except in Saudi Arabia, where the latter was mentioned). ~~Though~~ Although the predominance of materialistic considerations is consistent with previous studies (Singer 2011; Wlezien 2005), further research is needed to determine whether this arises from the

[13] The list of keywords is provided in Appendix **??**.

[14] The keyword matching searches the regular expression `global poverty|global inequal|hunger|drinking water|starv`, ignoring case. The automatic and manual classifications are based on the category definition "Inequality at the international level / Hunger or poverty in poor countries".

[15] Interestingly, out of the 47 (one-word) answers "poverty", (the zero-shot prompt passed to) ChatGPT-4.1 coded only 42 of them as *global inequality*, illustrating the lack of consistency of this classifier.

[16] At the country level, the concern for money is significantly correlated with inequality (an additional point in the Gini index is associated with 0.8 p.p. more respondents concerned with money). Interestingly, the concern for money is higher in richer countries, though the correlation vanishes once one controls for the Gini.

context (an impersonal survey) or truly reflects people's primary thoughts.

Figure 3: Most common concepts in open-ended fields. (Questions **??-??**)

(a) "What are your main concerns these days?"



(b) "What are your needs or wishes?"



(c) "What according to you is the greatest injustice of all?"



(d) "Can you name an issue that is important to you but is neglected in the public debate?"



Asked about the greatest *injustice*, ~~the most frequent answers relate to~~ respondents most frequently mention "inequality" or "poverty" ~~, with~~ (19% of ~~occurrences~~ (answers; 28% in Europe but only 9% in the U.S.). It is unclear whether these respondents are thinking about inequality in their own country or at the global level, since only 11% of

them specify a geographical scope. One clue is that 2% mention their own country versus 10% the global level (or Global South issues such as "clean water" or "starvation"). Italians, Poles, and Spaniards are the most likely to mention "global inequality" or "global poverty", while Japanese and Russian respondents are the least likely to do so. The next most common answers relate to "discrimination" (based on gender, race, or sexual orientation, 9%), "violence" or "wrongful convictions" (many respondents denounce the unjust sentencing of innocents, 9%), or their country's "welfare state" (with people criticizing either the lack of public services or the excessive welfare given to undeserving people, 8%).

Asking people about "an issue important to them but neglected in the public debate" fails to uncover unusual topics. One in five respondents (21%~~of respondents are unable to~~) cannot identify such an issue. The most frequently mentioned concepts are "public services" (12%), the "cost of living" (10%), "health" (9%), "ageing" (6%), and the "environment" (6%).[17] The fact that the most frequently mentioned topics are already well-publicized suggests that public debate reflects or shapes what people have in mind.

Reading and coding each field not only results in an arguably more accurate classification, but also offers insight into how people think. For example, most people reason from their own perspective (e.g., "my pension is too low", "I want to buy a house") and do not refer to the broader picture or to political reforms. To get a sense of respondents' own words, random selections of responses are ~~displayed at bit.ly/fields2025~~available online (link withheld for anonymized review). In addition to the manual classification presented in this section, I compiled a list of topics that are uniquely prevalent in each country, which I report in Appendix **??**.

The topics mentioned vary according to sociodemographic characteristics. For example, a respondent who mentions *immigration* is 3.5 times more likely to vote for the far right (correlation of .17); one who mentions *old age* is twice as likely to be 65 or older (correlation of .13). Beyond these examples, the strongest effects I find are that *criticizing the far right* correlates with voting for the left (.16), mentioning *health* with age (.11), *employment* with being unemployed (.09), *animals* with extending one's moral circle to sentient beings (.09), *education* with being a student (.09), *the environment* with voting for the left (.08), and *money* with one's income ($-.08$).

~~Our~~ The topic of interest here, *global inequality*, ~~does not emerge as an issue~~ is not salient to most people. Indeed, most considerations relate to issues that directly affect oneself or one's family, and political considerations (regarding e.g., public services, pen-

[17] Although "immigration" is one of the most frequent words according to the word cloud, the issue is only mentioned in 5% of cases.

sions, or taxes) are often framed at the national level. *Global redistribution* almost never appears as a *wish*. Furthermore, *global inequality* is rarely mentioned as a neglected *issue* or as a *concern*, in contrast to international issues such as war, climate change, or the rise of the far right. However, it is mentioned as frequently as these other international issues in terms of *injustice*.

In summary, the low salience of global solidarity may explain why this topic fails to mobilize political forces, despite being ~~referred to as~~ considered a just cause and ~~it~~ being accepted by majorities (as shown below).

III.B Prioritization of Public Spending Items

Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch (2025) find that 58% of Americans and 71% of Western Europeans would support a global tax on millionaires funding low-income countries (LICs), with only 26% and 14% opposing it, respectively. Meanwhile, around half of them would prefer to allocate half (rather than none) of the revenue from a global wealth tax to LICs. It seems that the more leeway respondents are granted to allocate the revenue from such a tax, the less they would allocate to LICs. The greatest leeway tested by Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch (2025) let the respondents select their preferred share for LICs versus domestic healthcare and education, and the average preference was 33.4% —that is, 66.8% of an equal split. Naturally, one expects respondents to split the revenue among all desirable spending items, so if LICs compete with not one but several national items, the share allocated to LICs is expected to diminish. If this share is less than 67% of an equal split, ~~it would mean~~ this would indicate that Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch (2025) overestimated the prioritization of LICs, perhaps due to an excessive salience of LICs when only one alternative is proposed, or because the domestic alternative —healthcare and education— was not the most desired. Conversely, if several items pertain to a global issue and each global item is considered individually desirable, the total "global spending" should rise proportionately.

To test whether the results in Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch (2025) provide an accurate picture of the prioritization of global spending ~~as well as~~ and to uncover the prioritization of different global causes, I conduct a revenue allocation task with five spending items. In each of the two variants of this task, respondents use sliders to allocate the revenue of a hypothetical global wealth tax (at a rate of 2% on wealth in excess of $5 million), after being informed of the revenue the tax would collect in their country (from $1 billion in Poland to $514 billion in the U.S.) versus in all LICs combined ($1 billion).

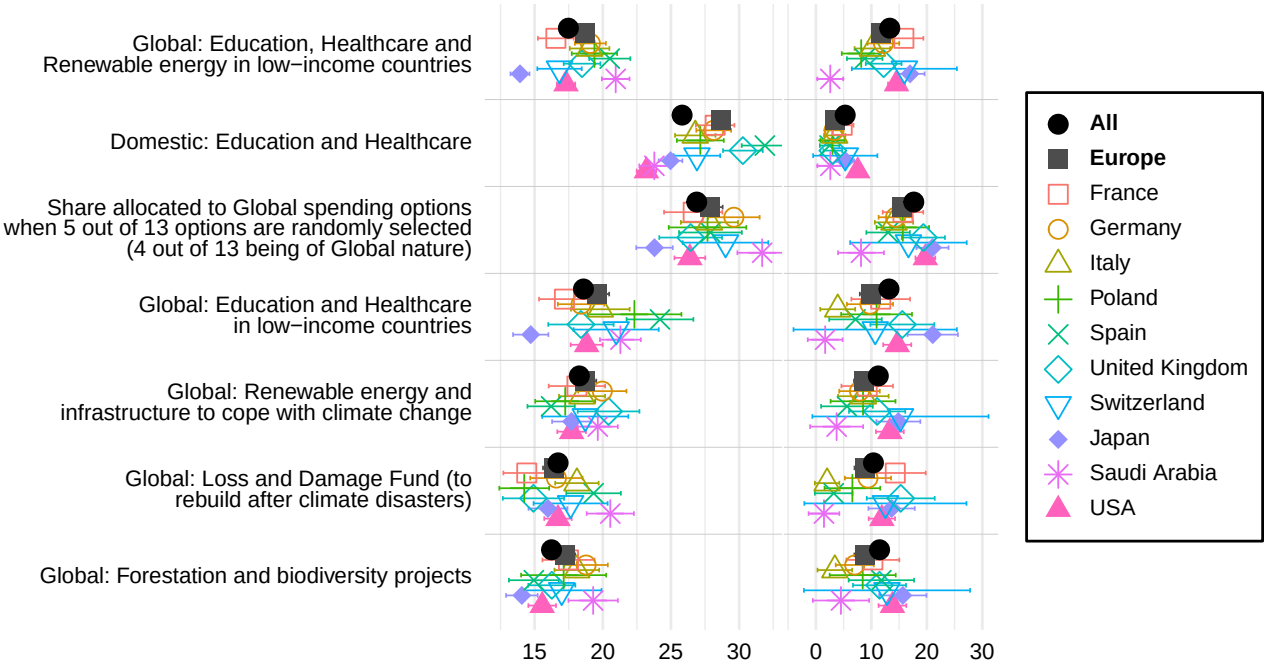
In the *Few* variant, one global item ("Education, Healthcare and Renewable energy in

LICs") competes with four domestic ones. In every country, the most prioritized item is "Domestic: Education and healthcare", with an average preferred share of 26% (Figures **??**, **??**). The global item is the least prioritized overall, at 17.5% (from 14% in Japan to 21% in Saudi Arabia and Spain). However, global spending is the second most prioritized item in Europe (19%) and Saudi Arabia. Furthermore, global spending is 31% higher than the expected 13.4% (that is, 66.8% of 20%)[18] and only 13% of respondents do not allocate any revenue to it (Figure 4).

Figure 4: Preferred split of revenue from a global wealth tax. The first two items are from the *Few* variant with 5 fixed items (the *Global* one and the most preferred one are displayed); the last four items are from the *Many* variant with 5 items taken at random out of 13 (the 4 *Global* ones are displayed). (Questions **??**-**??**)

(a) Average preferred allocation (in %).

(b) Share of respondents allocating 0 revenue (in %).



In the *Many* variant, five items are selected at random from a pool of four global and nine domestic items. While domestic healthcare (27%) and education (22%) are the most prioritized items, the average allocation for global items ranges from 16% for "Forestation and biodiversity projects" to 19% for "Education and Healthcare in LICs" (Figures

[18]The one-sided test that global spending is lower than 33.4% is rejected at the 1% threshold in all countries except Japan, where it is rejected at the 10% threshold. If one restricts the comparison to the countries surveyed by Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch (2025), the global item is allocated 17.8%, which is 34% more than expected. The most credible explanation for outperforming expectations is that the domestic item chosen by Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch (2025) was the preferred one. Indeed, the global item is allocated 68% of the "Domestic: Healthcare and Education" share, almost exactly as expected.

4, **??-??**). On average, tasks include 1.5 global items, which together receive 26.9% of the revenue —again, equivalent to 17.5% per global item. Interestingly, there is no significant correlation between the number of global items and the average allocation per global item.[19]

Overall, the revenue allocation tasks ~~validate and~~ confirm the findings from Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch (2025). Most people would favor using a substantial share of the revenue from a global wealth tax to finance sustainable development in LICs, even though global spending is somewhat less prioritized than domestic spending.

IV Acceptance of Policies as a Function of Country Coverage

While acceptance of global climate or redistributive policies is widespread (Cappelen, Støstad and Tungodden 2025; Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch 2025), acceptance may drop if policies are not truly *global* but only *international*, i.e., if key countries such as China, Russia, or the U.S. do not participate. Indeed, people may ~~be concerned about a domestic loss of competitiveness resulting from the expatriation of taxpayers~~ worry about a loss of domestic competitiveness if taxpayers relocate to low-tax jurisdictions~~;~~, or about unfair ~~burden-sharing~~ burden sharing if non-cooperating countries ~~free-ride~~ free ride on decarbonization or sustainable development funding. In this section, I examine the acceptance of globally redistributive policies depending on the coalition of countries that would implement them. I study, in turn, a carbon price and a wealth tax.

IV.A International Climate Scheme

Presentation of the Schemes. "Cap and dividend" is a reference climate policy (Baer et al. 2000; Barnes et al. 2008; Bertram 1992; Blanchard and Tirole 2021; Grubb 1990), whereby fossil fuel companies at the source of emissions must buy emission permits on a carbon market, ~~with~~ and the revenue from carbon pricing is rebated equally to individuals. The limited and declining number of emission permits guarantees that emissions are capped according to the climate objective. As polluting companies pass the cost of emission permits down the value chain, the carbon price is ultimately paid by consumers, in

[19] In Russia, the question could not be asked in the same way due to different software. Instead, respondents had to choose what share of the global tax revenue to allocate to sustainable development in low-income countries. On average, Russians allocate 12.2% to LICs, with a median allocation of just 5%, but only 12% allocate nothing to LICs.

proportion to their carbon footprint. Meanwhile, the equal cash transfer (or "dividend") offsets price increases for the average consumer. Those with a higher-than-average carbon footprint ~~financially lose~~ lose financially, while those with a lower carbon footprint (who are on average poorer) ~~financially~~ gain.

Using simple *Yes*/*No* questions, I test the acceptance of three types of "cap and dividend" (or "Climate Scheme") policies that differ by geographical scope: the National, Global, and International Climate Schemes (Figures 6, **??**). While average consumers in a high-income country are financially unaffected by the National Climate Scheme (NCS), they lose out in the Global and International versions, since their carbon footprint is larger than the world (or climate coalition) average.

The National Climate Scheme (NCS) is accepted by 68% of respondents (ranging from 56% in Poland to 88% in Saudi Arabia).[20]

The Global Climate Scheme. Before presenting the Global Climate Scheme (GCS), respondents are instructed to pay careful attention, with the incentive that they may win a $100 lottery prize if they correctly answer a comprehension question at the end of the survey. ~~When presented with the~~ The question informs respondents that the cash transfer of the Global Climate Scheme (GCS) ~~, respondents are informed that the cash transfer~~ would lift 600 million people out of extreme poverty, and it makes the cost to them ~~is made salient. Respondents are informed of~~ salient: respondents learn the amount of the cash transfer, ~~as well as~~ the price increases, and the net cost to the average person in their country (e.g., 2% price increases and a net cost of $90 per month in the U.S., or 2% and €45 per month in Germany).[21] The GCS is accepted by 55% of respondents (from 49% in the U.S. and Russia to 85% in Saudi Arabia). The salience of costs in the GCS question may explain the somewhat lower acceptance of the GCS compared to the NCS.[22]

[20] The acceptance of the NCS is higher than the support for a *tax*-and-dividend policy found in other surveys (Douenne and Fabre 2022; Mildenberger et al. 2022); for example, it is 12 p.p. higher than in Dechezleprêtre et al. (2025). Indeed, most people prefer emissions trading schemes to carbon taxes (Funke et al. 2025), and support drops (before recovering) in specific contexts, such as the Yellow Vests movement.

[21] The computations use a carbon price of \$95/tCO_2. For Russia, Saudi Arabia, and the U.S., computations assume universal country coverage and the cash transfer is $35 per month. For Europe and Japan, the net loss is computed in a non-universal but *High* participation scenario, which implies a lower cash transfer (€20 per month) and a higher net cost (by about $10 per month) since the coalition's average carbon footprint is lower than the world average. Appendix **??** reports the country-specific figures.

[22] Acceptance of the GCS is also around 10 p.p. lower than in Fabre, Douenne and Mattauch (2025). There may be ~~different~~ several reasons for this: attitudes may have changed ~~in~~ over the two-year interval~~;~~, and I added information on the price increases, which allows respondents to estimate the cost to themselves (rather than to their average fellow citizen).

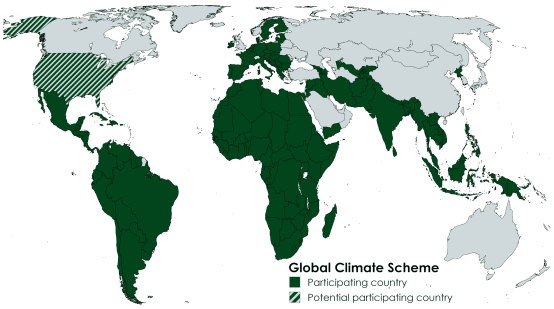
Pluralistic Ignorance. After ~~assessing~~ stating their own support for the GCS, respondents are asked~~in an incentivized way about their belief concerning the actual support~~ , with incentives, to estimate actual support for it, either in their country or in the U.S. (Figure **??**).[23] In every country and for any variant of the question, actual support is underestimated. The median respondent underestimates the support in their own country by 16 p.p. and the support in the U.S. by 22 p.p. In Japan and in European countries, the underestimation is more severe, with most people wrongly believing that the GCS does not garner majority support in their country. Such pluralistic ignorance might explain why politicians do not dare to propose global climate justice policies.

Interestingly, support is strongly correlated with the perception of support: 51% of respondents who support the GCS perceive it as supported by at least 50% in their own country, compared to only 24% of those who do not support it.[24] In other words, in addition to pluralistic ignorance, there is a false consensus effect.

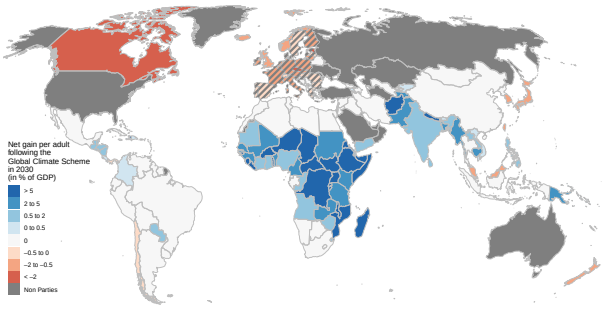
International Climate Scheme. To test how country coverage influences the acceptance of the International Climate Scheme (ICS), respondents are randomly assigned to one of four variants. They can visualize the country coverage on a map (see examples in Figure 5), where their own country is striped to denote its potential participation. Respondents are also informed of the number of countries that would participate in the assigned scenario, the list of these countries or world regions, and their share of world emissions.

Figure 5: Example maps of the International Climate Scheme question. (Question **??**).

(a) *Low* variant for the U.S.



(b) *High color* variant for EU countries.

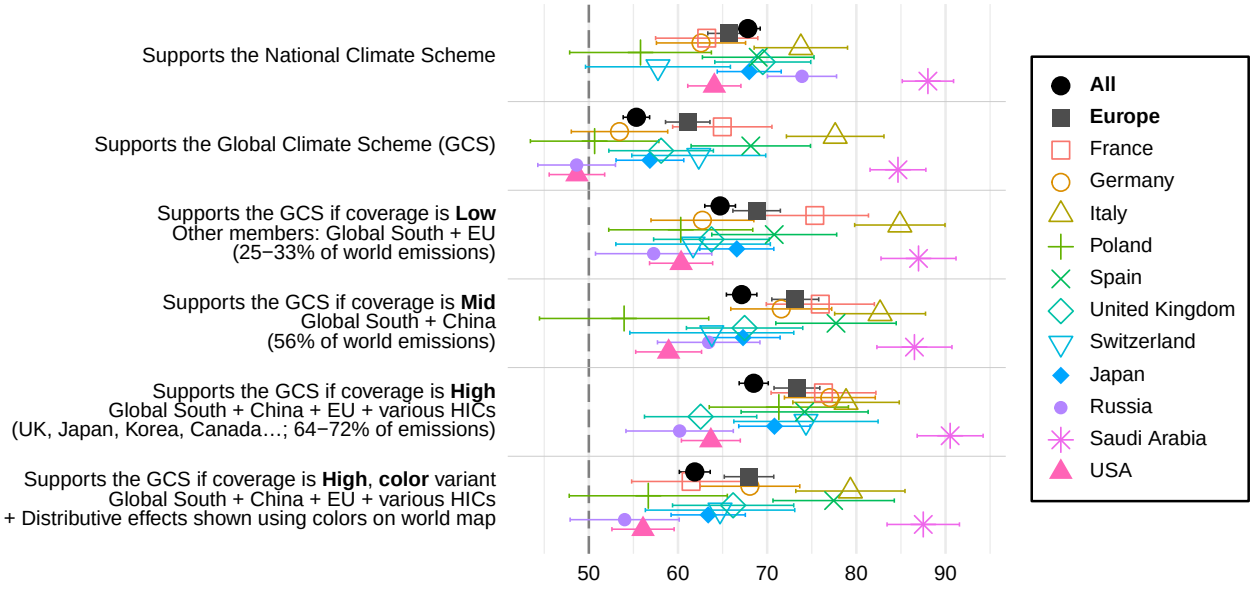


[23] Americans are asked about either their country or the EU. In Russia, I was not permitted to ~~enquire~~ inquire about beliefs regarding a foreign country.

[24] The median perception of support in one's own country is 20 p.p. higher among those who support the GCS (50% versus 30%). Reciprocally, support for the GCS reaches 72% among the 39% of respondents who believe that a majority in their country supports it, compared to 44% among those who do not.

The *Mid* scenario covers 56% of world emissions and includes China and Global South countries. The *Low* scenario replaces China with the EU and covers 33% of emissions. The *High*~~*scenario*~~ scenario adds various high-income countries to the *Mid* scenario, including the EU, the UK, Japan, Canada, and South Korea, and covers 72% of emissions. The last variant, *High color*, combines the *High* participation scenario with a colored map that displays not only the country coverage, but also the net gain or cost for each country, with China appearing as neither gaining nor losing from the policy.[25]

Figure 6: Percentage of support for the National, Global, and International Climate Schemes (*Yes*/*No* questions). (Questions **??-??**.)



As expected, the wider the coverage, the higher the acceptance. However, this effect is relatively small, as acceptance is only 3.8 p.p. higher in the *High* variant (at 68%) ~~compared to~~ than in the *Low* variant (65%). Interestingly, acceptance among Europeans significantly increases when China is added to the coalition, but does not rise further when other HICs are also added. Conversely, for Americans and Japanese, the participation of the EU or China yields similar levels of acceptance, and only the combined participation of China, the EU, and other HICs significantly increases acceptance.

The effect of country coverage is entirely driven by the 74% of respondents who understand that the GCS would result in increased gasoline prices. It is worth noting that acceptance is higher among the minority of respondents who misunderstand the policy: by 5 p.p. for the GCS and 4 p.p. for the ICS.

[25] In a standard cap and dividend, China should lose, as its carbon footprint exceeds the world average. However, the Global Climate Scheme departs slightly from the standard policy so that middle-income countries do not lose out (Fabre 2025).

Acceptance is 6.6 p.p. lower in the *High color* variant ~~compared to~~ than in the *High* variant. Three reasons may explain this effect. First, the cost may be more salient with the colored map. Second, some respondents may be concerned by the information (made explicit in the question) that China would neither gain nor lose from the policy. Third, with the colored map, respondents learn how their own country fares compared to others. In fact, the effect is no longer significant (and of opposite sign) for countries that appear to lose less than 0.5% of their GDP (Spain and Switzerland).

Not~~ic~~e that acceptance of the ICS in the *Low* coverage variant is similar to that of the NCS. This suggests that the average respondent is willing to pay the ICS's higher cost for the guarantee of poverty alleviation and decarbonization in the Global South.

Finally, the greater acceptance of the ICS compared to the GCS is somewhat puzzling. Perhaps people view the proposal as more credible when a list of participating countries is provided, compared to the GCS, which is framed as if all countries might join (or, on the contrary, as one in which the participation of any country is uncertain). Relatedly, acceptance may be stronger for more precise or more visual proposals, either because they are viewed as more advanced or because they induce an experimenter demand bias. The greater acceptance could also be due to costs being less salient in the ICS question (but acceptance is still greater than in the GCS in the *High color* variant, where costs are visible). Unfortunately, the data ~~does not allow testing these different~~ do not allow me to test these hypotheses.

IV.B Wealth Tax Funding LICs

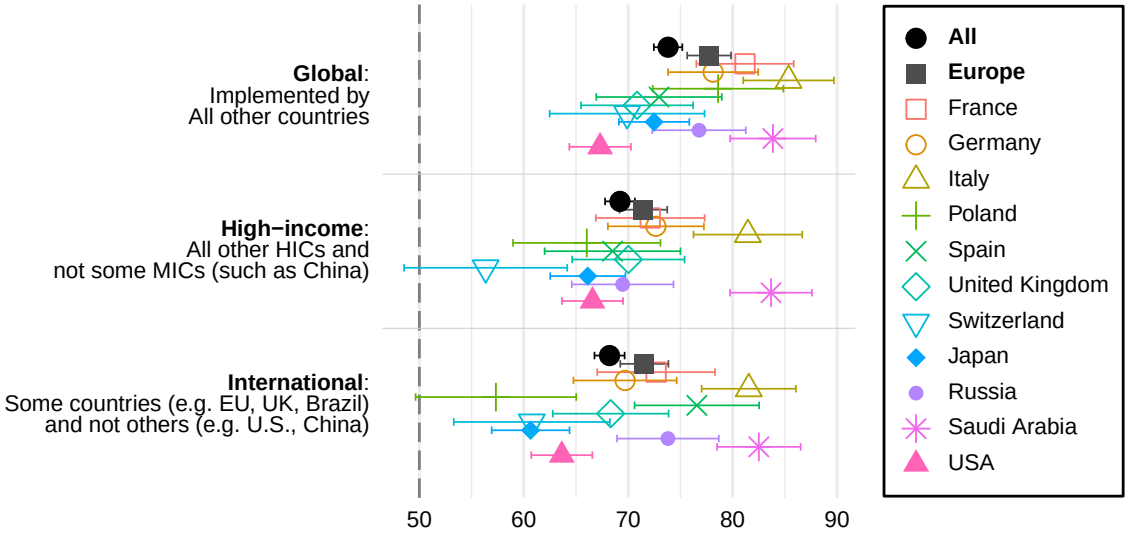
I test the effect of country coverage on the acceptance of an internationally redistributive wealth tax using a simple *Yes*/*No* question with three random variants. The policy is described as a 2% tax on wealth above $1 million, with 30% of its revenue financing public services in LICs. In the *Global* variant, all countries except the respondent's own are assumed to participate. The *HIC* variant covers all HICs (except the respondent's country). The *International* variant covers some countries and not others, with the precise coverage varying by respondent's country but always including Brazil and European countries (or the whole EU) and excluding China and the U.S.[26]

Here again, acceptance increases with ~~the~~ country coverage, but the effect is small. The middle-ground *HIC* variant garners 70% acceptance (from 58% in Switzerland to 81% in Saudi Arabia). Compared to *HIC*, acceptance is 4.8 p.p. higher with *Global* coverage,

[26] More precisely, in the U.S., excluded countries differ and are *China, Japan, and Canada*. As for included countries, in addition to *Brazil*, they are: *the EU and the UK* for Switzerland, Saudi Arabia, and the U.S.; *the EU* for Russia and the UK; and *France, Germany, Spain, and the UK (except one's own country)* for EU countries.

while it is only 1.4 p.p. and non-significantly lower with *International* coverage (Figure 7).

Figure 7: Percentage of support for an international wealth tax with 30% of revenue funding LICs, depending on the country coverage (*Yes*/*No* question). (Questions **??-??**).



Overall, the results indicate that the acceptance of internationally redistributive policies is quite robust to country coverage. This ~~confirms that the issues of competitiveness or~~ suggests that competitiveness and free riding are not decisive factors in public support (Aklin and Mildenberger 2020).

V Sincerity of Support for Global Redistribution

Skeptics ~~about~~ of the public's support for global redistribution would argue that this support is not reflected in real-stake decisions or that it mostly results from *warm glow*. According to the *warm glow* hypothesis, many people would express their support to enjoy moral comfort as long as the policy appears out of reach and supporting it seems harmless. In case of *warm glow*, support would vanish if (*i*) the prospect of implementation materialized or if (*ii*) moral comfort could be obtained from a substitute. In this section, I test whether global redistribution is a vote-determining issue using a conjoint analysis, and I test both forms of *warm glow* (*i* and *ii*) using two other survey experiments.

V.A Conjoint Analysis

I conduct a conjoint experiment in all countries except Russia and Saudi Arabia. This question is positioned at the beginning of the survey, before respondents know the survey's topic. Respondents are presented with two random political programs, framed as

the fictitious programs of the leading candidates in the next election, and are asked which candidate they would vote for (27% of the respondents choose the outside option *Neither of them*). Each program contains a policy or an absence of policy, chosen at random, for each of five policy domains (the order of which is also randomized). ~~Our~~ The domain of interest is *Foreign policy*, whose pool contains three policies: *Cut development aid*, *International tax on millionaires with 30% financing healthcare and education in low-income countries*, and a country-specific policy. ~~The policies, except for these two~~ Apart from the two policies of interest, ~~have been~~ the policies were selected from the programs of the main candidates in the country's most recent election, ensuring coverage of the entire political spectrum and of the most prominent proposals in the national public debate.

Figure 8 shows the effect of including ~~our~~ the policies of interest in a program on the likelihood that it is preferred (see Figures **??**-**??** for full country-by-country results[27]). More specifically, following Hainmueller, Hopkins and Yamamoto (2014), Figure 8 and Table **??** present the results of the following regression, estimated by simple OLS with standard errors clustered by respondent:[28]

$$\text{Preferred}_{pi} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{Cut_aid}_{pi} + \beta_2 \text{Intl_tax}_{pi} + \beta_3 \text{Foreign3}_{pi} + \varepsilon_{pi} \quad (1)$$

where pi denotes the program p faced by respondent i, and each variable is a dummy.

Both policies significantly affect program choice: the internationally redistributive millionaire tax increases the likelihood that a program is preferred by 5 p.p., while cutting development aid decreases it by 3 p.p. At the country level, the effects are generally ~~non-significant due to~~ not significant due to a lack of power, but when significant, they ~~are of~~ have the same sign as the ~~global~~ pooled effect. On average, the effects of the tax are of similar size to the effects of other policies,[29] suggesting that certain global redistribution proposals may be as vote-determining as policies prominent in the national debate.

One concern with this type of conjoint analysis is that it involves unrealistic political programs, ~~namely~~ such as programs that contain both left-wingand far-right policies,

[27] With a few exceptions, *raising the minimum wage* is among the most popular policies, alongside *redistributive taxes or transfers*, *anti-immigration regulations*, and *abortion rights*. Conversely, *a ban on new combustion-engine cars* is among the least popular ones.

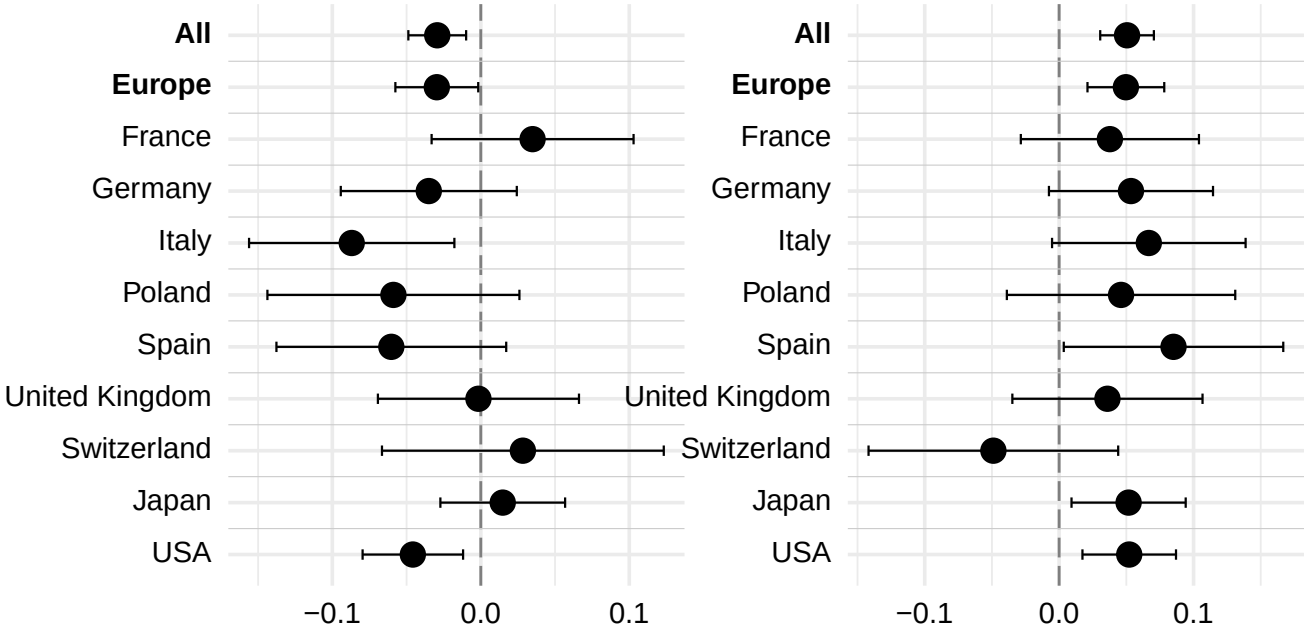
[28] More specifically, I estimate the average marginal component effect (AMCE), which is the change in the probability that a program is chosen if a policy is present rather than not, averaged across all possible values in the other policy domains. Hainmueller, Hopkins and Yamamoto (2014) show that the linear model is an unbiased estimator of the AMCE under uniform and independent randomization of attributes. I verify that the results are similar when using a conditional logit: the average marginal effects of *Int'l tax* and *Cut aid* are 6 p.p. and -3 p.p., respectively.

[29] A simple permutation test shows that the effects~~s~~of the *int'l tax* is not significantly ~~lower~~ smaller than the average absolute effect size (it is ~~just~~ only 4% ~~lower~~smaller, $p = .48$)~~but~~, whereas the effects~~s~~of *cut aid* is significantly ~~lower~~ smaller ($p = .01$).

Figure 8: Effect on the likelihood that a political program is preferred of containing the following policies (compared to no foreign policy in the program). No control is included, 95% confidence intervals are shown. (See Figure **??** for effects by vote.) (Question **??**)

(a) Cut development aid

(b) International tax on millionaires with 30% financing health and education in low-income countries



which ~~distorts the actual choices that voters may~~ do not reflect the choices voters actually face. De la Cuesta, Egami and Imai (2022) ~~showed that~~show that, to fully address this issue, one should weighteach pair of programs by the probability that it would arise in a real election. Since this probability cannot be computed, the best practice is to bound the effects by estimating them with extreme probabilities. The results just presented are based on one extreme, the uniform distribution. To construct the other extreme, I classify each policy proposal according to its originating political party[30] and consider a program consistent if it does not contain policies from both the *left* and the *far right*. Then, I re-estimate the regression after dropping the 29% of pairs with an inconsistent program, effectively assigning them a probability of zero. ~~Effects are preserved~~The effects are unchanged: +5 p.p. for the tax and −3 p.p. for cutting aid.[31] This indicates that the results are robust to the critique of De la Cuesta, Egami and Imai (2022).

[30]Interestingly, the most popular policies originate from left-wing parties, except in Germany and Switzerland. Indeed, the average deviation from the mean effect is highest for policies originating from the *Left*, and lowest for those from the *Center-right or Right*.

[31]In the main specification, I consider ~~our~~ the policies of interest ~~as~~ consistent with any program. As an alternative, I classify them as either *left* (for the tax) or *far right* (for cutting aid). In that case, only 43% of observations are retained, yet effects are still preserved (+5 p.p. for the tax and −4 p.p. for cutting aid).

V.B Testing Warm Glow

Some people might claim to support a policy of global redistribution merely to ease their conscience. If support were mainly due to this psychological mechanism, called *warm glow*, it might dissipate when the prospect of the policy materializes or if ~~the policy support could be replaced by~~ a substitute with the same moral appeal were available.

Moral Substitute. Following Nunes and Schokkaert (2003), warm glow would be revealed if support for the GCS decreased after respondents ~~are~~ were offered the opportunity to express generosity towards~~s~~the cause of climate change. To test this hypothesis, right before the GCS page, I assign a random subset of ~~the~~ respondents to a donation lottery, while the control group faces no question.[32] In the *Donation* branch, respondents must decide how much they would donate to the reforestation NGO *Just One Tree*, should they win the question's $100 lottery. Lower support for the GCS in the treated group would be evidence of warm glow, or moral licensing, as it would indicate that the support derives (at least part~~ial~~ly) from moral satisfaction at having recently supported a just cause.

On the contrary, support for the GCS is 3 p.p. higher in the *Donation* branch ~~compared to~~ than in the control group, and the coefficient is positive in every country, though often not significant (Figure 9a, Table **??**). While the reason for this positive effect remains unclear,[33] the results show no evidence of warm glow.

Realism Treatment. To test the hypothesis that some people express support for global redistribution only as long as its implementation seems unlikely, I randomly assign half of ~~the~~ respondents to receive information about ongoing negotiations on globally redistributive policies. Among other things, treated respondents are informed that the International Maritime Organization recently adopted a levy on maritime carbon emissions that should partly finance LICs; that the G20 considered introducing a global tax on billionaires; that the UN General Assembly recently agreed on the principle of expanding the UN Security Council to new members; and that the UN Secretary-General supports financial system reforms that would drive resources towards sustainable development (see

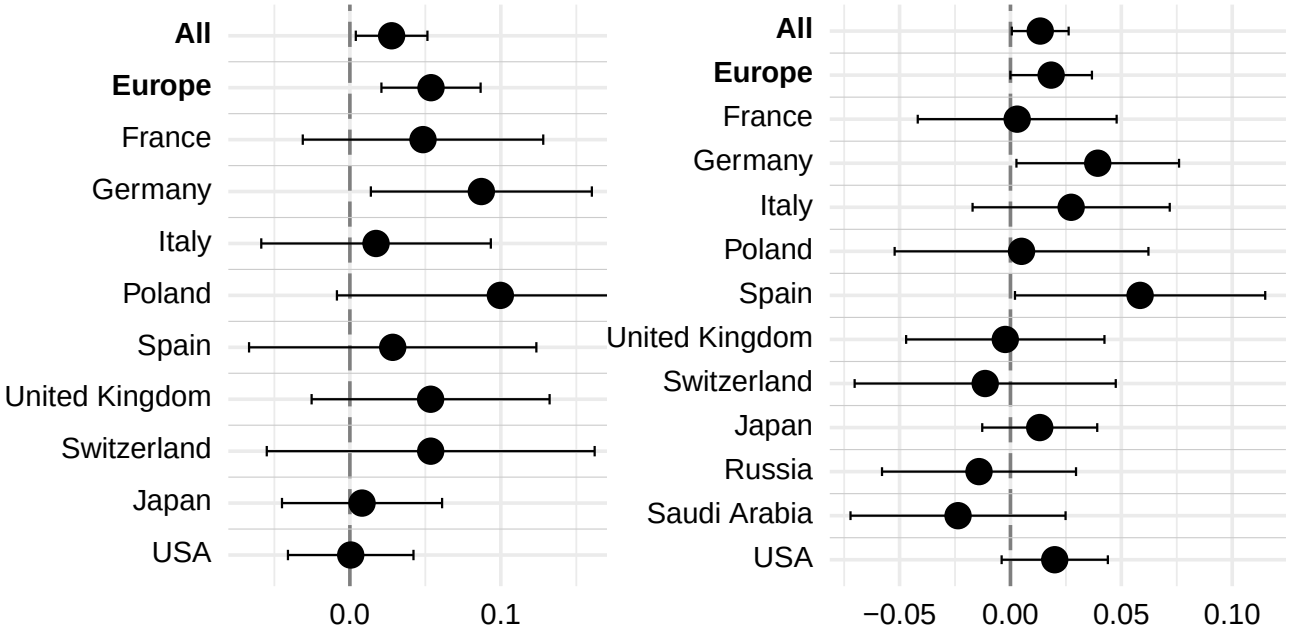
[32] More precisely, right before the GCS question, the sample is split into three branches: the *Donation* lottery, the *NCS* question, and the control group. The NCS treatment is excluded from this analysis as it is unrelated to this experiment (restricting the NCS question to a subsample was done to prevent it from influencing responses to the GCS).

[33] Perhaps the *Donation* question triggers thoughts favorable to the GCS, such as the realization that individual actions like donations are ill-suited to address climate change, so that we need a global policy, even if it is imperfect.

Figure 9: Testing warm glow (negative effects would indicate the presence of warm glow). Regressions include controls, 95% confidence intervals are shown.

(a) Effect of a *Donation lottery* treatment on support for the Global Climate Scheme. (Questions **??**-**??**)

(b) Effect of information about ongoing global redistribution initiatives on the share of plausible global policies supported. (Questions **??**-**??**)



Question **??**). Then, respondents are asked "how likely [it is] that international policies involving significant transfers from HICs to LICs will be introduced in the next 15 years", right before being asked about their support for ten plausible global policies~~is tested~~.[34] Here, warm glow would be revealed if the information treatment increased the belief that global redistribution is likely but decreased support for global policies.

The treatment was designed to satisfy the exclusion restriction required for the instrumental variables (IV) strategy. The exclusion restriction states that the treatment affects support for global policies only through its impact on beliefs that global redistribution is likely. Table 1 reports the corresponding regression results. Although the treatment is randomly assigned, the preferred specification includes ~~the~~ sociodemographic variables as controls to improve ~~accuracy~~precision.[35] Informed respondents are 7 p.p. more likely to believe that global redistribution is likely, from a baseline of 33% in the control group. With an effective F-statistic of 67, this highly significant effect provides a strong first stage for the IV estimation. Assuming that the exclusion restriction holds, the IV is well identified. The local average treatment effect estimated by 2SLS is 18 p.p., indicating that

[34] Section VI.A reports acceptance of these policies and Appendix **??** describes the corresponding international negotiations.

[35] See Table **??** for results without controls.

believing global redistribution is likely causally *increases* the share of global policies supported. This estimate is consistent with both the non-causal OLS coefficient of 15 p.p. and the direct effect of the treatment on policy support, estimated at 1 p.p. (see Figure 9b and Table **??**).

Table 1: Effect on support for global redistribution of believing that it is likely.

	Believes global redistribution likely		Share of plausible global policies supported		
	IV 1st Stage	IV 1st Stage	IV 2nd Stage	OLS	Direct Effect
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)
Information treatment	0.077	0.074			0.013
	(0.010)	(0.009)			(0.007)
Believes global redistribution likely			0.181	0.145	
			(0.086)	(0.007)	
(Intercept)	0.332	0.078	0.216	0.220	0.230
	(0.007)	(0.067)	(0.065)	(0.064)	(0.066)
Controls: sociodemos and vote		✓	✓	✓	✓
Effective F-statistic	65.04	67.09			
Observations	12,001	12,001	12,001	12,001	12,001
R^2	0.006	0.134	0.174	0.176	0.141

*Note: Robust standard errors (HC1) are reported in parentheses. ~~*p<0.1; **p<0.05; ***p<0.01.~~ As in Appendix **??**, control variables are: vote, gender, age, income, education, urbanity, likelihood of becoming millionaire, living with partner, employment status, foreign born, country region.*

Again, the effects go in the ~~opposite direction~~ direction opposite to warm glow. ~~In this case~~Here, increased support may stem from the enhanced credibility of policies ~~that are~~ known to be discussed in international organizations. Overall, the results of these two experiments provide no evidence that support for global redistribution is affected by warm glow. On the contrary, they suggest that support is sincere and robust to the prospect of implementation ~~or to the possibility~~ and to the availability of a moral substitute.

VI Breadth of Accepted International Policies

~~Knowing~~ Having shown that some internationally redistributive policies are sincerely supported and may influence voting behavior, I now examine the range of international policies that could be accepted. In ~~this section~~turn, I analyze ~~, in turn, the~~ support for global policies currently debated in the international community ~~, as well as~~ and for more

radical proposals~~; I also assess~~ , assess the broader willingness to defend global solidarity, analyze the preferred channels ~~to transfer~~ for transferring resources to LICs, and ~~I~~ use a custom redistribution task to reveal the preferred extent of international transfers.

VI.A Acceptance of Currently Debated Global Policies

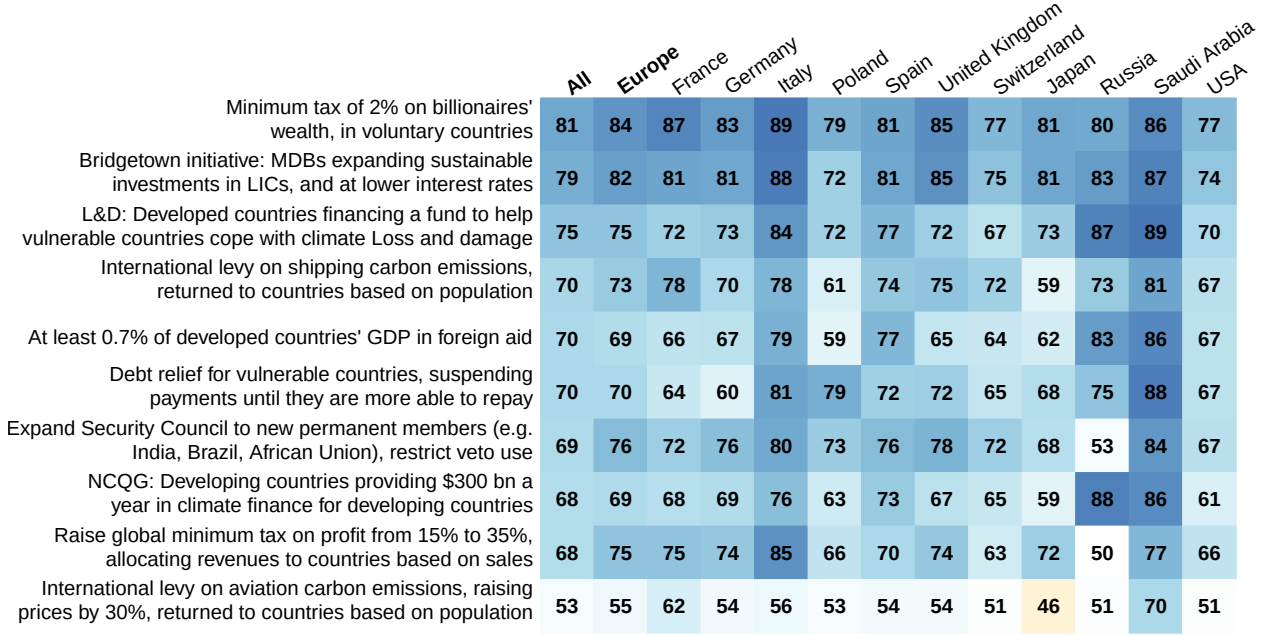
Plausible Global Policies. Figure 10 ~~reveals~~ shows the acceptance of plausible global policies (see Figure **??** for absolute support). These policies are deemed "plausible" because they are debated in international organizations, as detailed in Appendix **??**. Almost every policy garners majority acceptance in each country. The only exception is ~~the acceptance among Japanese respondents of~~ a globally redistributive tax on carbon emissions from aviation, ~~at~~ which 46% of Japanese respondents accept. This proposal, which has the most salient cost ~~:~~ (a 30% increase in flight prices~~. It~~), is the least supported in every country. The most supported policies, with over two-thirds acceptance in every country and a majority of absolute support in the pooled sample, are the 2% minimum tax on billionaires' wealth proposed by Zucman (2024), the expansion of low-interest-rate sustainable investments in LICs (Bridgetown Initiative 2025), and ~~developed countries contributing~~ contributions by developed countries to the climate loss and damage fund. Figure **??** shows that most policies garner majority support across the political spectrum in Europe and Japan, whereas Trump voters oppose more policies than they support.

Ranking of Countries in Terms of Support for Global Redistribution. On average, respondents support 51% of the plausible policies and oppose 21% of them. ~~This means they support +~~That is, they support 30 p.p. more policies than they oppose (Figure **??**). The countries with the highest mean difference between support and opposition are Saudi Arabia (+50 p.p.), Italy (+49) and Spain (+39). In contrast, net support is lowest in Japan (+20), Switzerland (+24), Poland, and the U.S. (+25).

Other synthetic indicators of support for global redistribution show consistent country rankings. In particular, the countries previously identified as having the highest and lowest net support retain their rankings when ordered by average latent support for global redistribution (Figure **??**). To construct this latent variable, I standardize all variables of support and average them, weighted by loadings obtained from an exploratory factor analysis (see details and loading weights in Appendix **??**).

One might wonder why the countries leading in support are the Saudi kingdom and right-wing-dominated Italy. ~~Breaking down the~~ Figures **??**-**??**, which break down support by political leaning and other selected sociodemographics, ~~Figures **??**-**??**~~ shed some light

Figure 10: Acceptance of plausible global redistribution policies (Percentage of *Somewhat* or *Strongly support* among non-*Indifferent* responses). See Figure **??** for the absolute support. (Question **??**).



on this question. In Saudi Arabia, half of the adult population ~~is immigrant~~consists of immigrants. However, foreign workers do not drive the results, as Saudi citizens exhibit slightly higher support than non-Saudis.[36] As for Italy, it is both the country with the lowest gap in support between left-wing and far-right voters (along with Japan, at 33 p.p.) and the country with the highest support among left-wing voters.[37]

Climate Finance Goal. Climate finance refers to the financing of climate action in developing countries by developed countries. In 2024, countries agreed on a "New Collective Quantified Goal" (NCQG) of climate finance set at $300 billion per year by 2035, which is triple the previous goal. However, while developing countries such as India called for $600 billion in grants (or grant-equivalent funding), the NCQG does not specify the share of finance that should be provided as grants. Currently, ~~the goal is being met with~~ climate finance includes only $26 billion in grants~~and the remainder in~~ , the remainder being loans (OECD 2024).

[36] ~~Therefore, tentative~~ Tentative explanations may ~~rather come from~~ therefore lie in Saudi society. While Saudis benefit from a generous welfare state, the Islamic pillar of *Zakat* (almsgiving) might further foster a culture of generosity.

[37] ~~While the~~ The former point may be linked to the ~~vision of Italy's~~ Italian far-right leader's vision of an Africa-~~-~~Italy partnership (trading ~~off~~ foreign aid ~~with~~ for cooperation ~~in fighting~~ against immigration), while the Italian population ~~might~~ may also be influenced by the Vatican's messages in favor of global solidarity.

I test the preferred amount for the NCQG in grant-equivalent terms, using two random variants. Both variants inform respondents of the current situation and the agreed goal, expressing amounts in both absolute terms and as a proportion of developed countries' GDP. The *Short* variant uses qualitative, textual responses ~~,~~and features a middle category of $100 billion (namely, "Meet the newly agreed goal by tripling grants and loans ($100 billion in grants, or 0.15% of GDP)."). The *Full* variant provides more detailed explanations in the question text and then uses numerical answers, with a midpoint of $300 billion.

In both variants, the median preferred NCQG is $100 billion in grants, with 19% of respondents choosing an amount of $600 billion or larger (Figures **??-??**).

~~That~~ The fact that differently framed variants yield consistent results suggests that, despite its length, the question was well understood. ~~The median choice of a climate finance quantum~~ That the median preferred amount is in line with the internationally agreed NCQG can be interpreted in two ~~distinct ways. Either diplomats of HICs are defending~~ ways: either HIC diplomats defend the level of generosity that reflects ~~the median preferences of their compatriots~~their compatriots' median preferences, or respondents' attitudes are anchored in existing agreements (or in their ~~governments'~~government's stance). The results presented below are more consistent with the latter interpretation, as they reveal majority acceptance of much larger international transfers.

VI.B Support for Radical Proposals, Political Action, and Broad Values

In the final part of the questionnaire, I pose a variety of questions to assess the range of global solidarity policies, actions or values that people may accept (Figure 11).

Sustainable Future versus Status Quo. Respondents were asked which scenario they would prefer for the next twenty years: a sustainable future or the status quo (note that scenarios were not labeled that way in the questionnaire, but were instead randomly named *A* or *B*). In the sustainable scenario, most countries cooperate to tax millionaires and meet the +2°C target, through the electrification of cars and the doubling of prices for heating fuel or gas, air travel, and beef. Although overall purchasing power is preserved (through a reduction in sales tax), people change their habits (e.g., flying and eating meat are cut by half). In the status quo, no policy is implemented, people maintain their lifestyles, and global warming reaches +3°C by 2100, causing more severe disasters.

Overall, 68% of respondents prefer the sustainable future over the status quo.

Global Income Redistribution. I test ~~the~~ support for a global tax on top incomes to finance poverty reduction in LICs, with the tax targeting either the global top 1% or top 3%, depending on random assignment. The top 1% variant describes an additional 15% tax on after-tax individual income in excess of $120,000 per year (at Purchasing Power Parity), while the top 3% variant features additional rates of 15%, 30%, and 45% above $80,000, $120,000, and $1 million, respectively. Each tax is calibrated to finance the poverty gap, with poverty defined using thresholds of $250 and $400 per month for the top 1% and top 3% variants, respectively. These taxes entail international transfers of 2% and 5% of world nominal income, respectively (see Appendix **??** for details). Two numerical examples explain to respondents how the tax would affect taxpayers' income. The question also states the share of affected taxpayers worldwide and in their country, as well as the share of their country's GDP that would be transferred. For example, in the U.S., the top 1% tax would affect the top 8% and transfer 3% of GDP, while the top 3% tax would affect the top 18% and transfer 8% of GDP (see Figure **??**). These figures are about half as high in Japan and Germany, and ~~around four times lower~~ about a quarter as high in France and Spain.

Overall, 56% (resp. 50%) of the respondents support the top 1% (resp. top 3%) tax, and 25% (resp. 28%) oppose it (Figure **??**). The top 1% tax obtains ~~majority of absolute~~ an absolute majority of support in every country except Japan. Both variants are accepted by a majority in every ~~case except Switzerland for~~ country, except the top 3% variant ~~(in which case~~ in Switzerland (where it would affect 18% of ~~Swiss people would be affected~~the population). Overall, the tax garners majority acceptance even among the 6% of respondents who would be affected, though this is not the case in every country for the top 3% variant (Figure **??**).

Global Convergence. A simple question captures the acceptance of global solidarity: "Should governments actively cooperate to have all countries converge in terms of GDP per capita by the end of the century?" Overall, 61% answer *Yes* and 26% *No*, with the lowest relative agreement (i.e., excluding people not responding) in the U.S., at 56%.

Willingness to Act. Two questions asked the respondents how they would react to a "worldwide movement in favor of a global program to tackle climate change, implement taxes on millionaires and fund poverty reduction in [LICs]".

In a multiple-choice question (censored in Russia), 29% report they could participate in the movement by ~~either~~ attending a demonstration (19%), going on strike (7%), or donating $100 to a strike fund (10%). ~~This share rises to 68% in favor of the movement~~

~~when including the~~ Including the 52% of respondents who "could sign a petition and spread ideas", 68% are in favor of the movement (Figure **??**). Interestingly, 52% of the 584 millionaires[38] who answered the survey would be in favor of such a movement.

When asked whether they would be more or less likely to vote for the political party they feel closest to if it were part of such a movement, 36% of ~~the~~ respondents state they would be more likely versus 17% less likely (Figure **??**). Among the 5% of respondents who did not vote in the last election and feel closest to a left-wing party, the share who would be more likely to vote ~~in that case increases~~ for it rises to 46% (versus 10% who are less likely).

Reasons for Helping LICs. In a multiple-choice question, I asked respondents which reasons for HICs ~~supporting~~ to support LICs they agree with, among arguments involving *duty*, *long-term interest*, or *historical responsibility*. At 54%, the reason most frequently chosen in every country (except France) is *duty*, specifically "Helping countries in need is the right thing to do" (Figure **??**). Additionally, 38% select *interest*, and 25% *responsibility*, with only 16% disagreeing with every reason.

Reparations. In former colonial or slave States,[39] I asked respondents whether they would support "reparations for colonization and slavery to former colonies and descendants of slaves", specifying that the reparations "could take the form of funding education and facilitating technology transfers". Consistent with the ~~general disagreement~~ widespread rejection of the idea that HICs have a *historical* responsibility to support LICs, only a minority of 35% of respondents support reparations (except in Italy where 56% do), while 42% oppose them (Figure **??**). This suggests that framing global solidarity as a decolonial struggle might be counterproductive for its advocates.

Agreement That Own Taxes Should Solve Global Problems. Overall, 41% agree and 28% disagree that "[their] taxes should go towards solving global problems". With 60% relative agreement, there is a relative majority in favor of one's own taxes financing global solidarity, though a lower one than for specific proposals that would make the richest contribute.[40] ~~As explained in Section II, the present results replicate well~~ The present

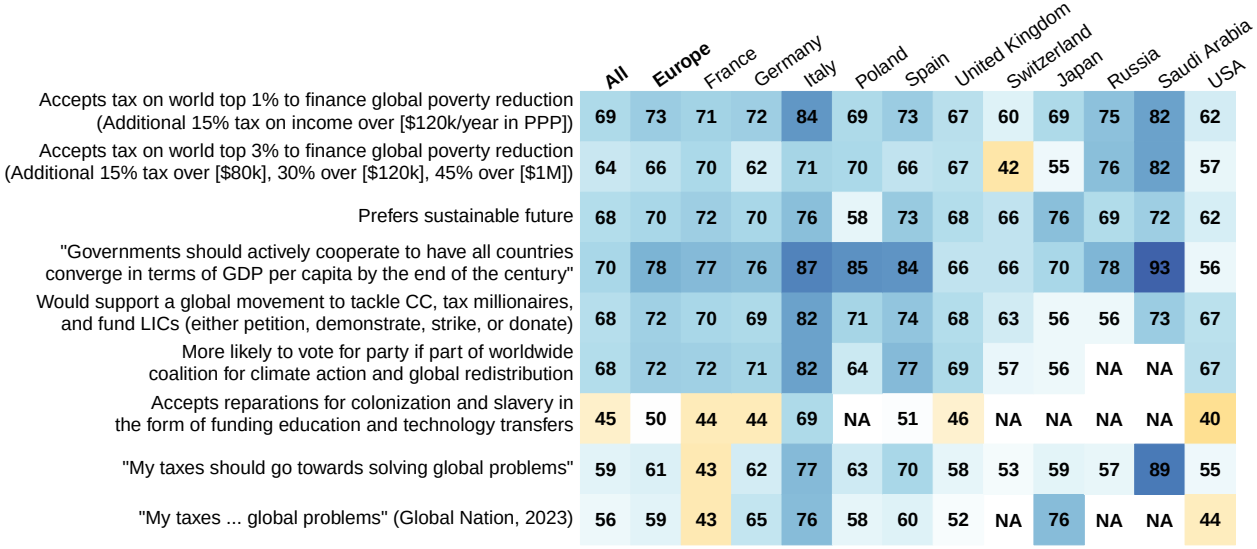
[38] In the weighted subsample of millionaires, 60% are Americans and 26% Europeans.

[39] I did not ask this question in Japan or Russia, because these countries' historiographies do not present their past as colonial but rather as an empire.

[40] This confirms that the willingness to pay for global solidarity, even through taxes, does not equate to acceptance of global redistribution proposals.

results closely replicate those of the "Global Solidarity Report"~~that~~, which first asked this question (Global Nation 2023).

Figure 11: Acceptance of broad action or radical proposals of global redistribution. (Questions **??-??**, **??-??**, **??**, **??**).



Moral Circle. Asked "Which group of people do you advocate for when you vote?",[41] 45% select a universalist answer ("Humans" or "Sentient beings (humans and animals)"), ~~which is~~ more than the ~~most common answer, referring to one's~~ share choosing their fellow citizens (32%), the most common single answer. Universalists are fewer in Japan (30%) but constitute a majority in Europe (50%) and Saudi Arabia (57%), as shown in Figures 12 and **??**. Among those who lean to the left, 59% are universalists, compared to 32% on the center-right or far-right.

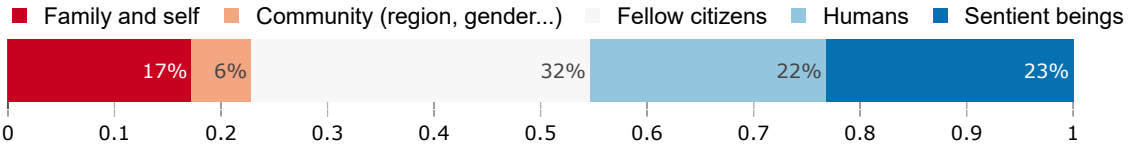
Following Enke et al. (2024), I construct an alternative measure of universalism based on the vocabulary used in open-ended fields.[42] Although latent support for global redistribution is significantly correlated with this measure, the correlation is only .05, less than the correlation with manual, keyword, or AI classifications of a field as relating to inequality or poverty (at .09, .08, and .06, respectively), and much less than the correlation with

[41] In Russia and Saudi Arabia, the question was asked differently. It read: "Which group do you advocate for? For example, if you were the richest person on Earth, which group would you predominantly help with your money?"

[42] More specifically, I use the Moral Foundation Dictionary (MFD) 2.0 (Frimer, Chan and darloap 2019) and define *universalism* as the number of occurrences of *care* or *fairness* words minus the number of *loyalty* or *authority* words. I also test an alternative definition, based on the extended MFD (Hopp et al. 2021), that uses weights rather than dummy variables to indicate a word's belonging to a moral dimension. The latter definition is even less (though still significantly) correlated with the latent support for global redistribution, at .03.

~~our universalism variable based on moral circle~~ the moral-circle measure of universalism (at .37). Furthermore, the correlation between the two measures of universalism is only .03. This ~~observation demonstrates~~ shows that the various indicators labeled as "universalism" by different authors may not all capture the same dimension.

Figure 12: "Which group of people do you advocate for when you vote?"[41] (Question **??**).



VI.C Preferred Channels for Transferring Resources to LICs

Asked to evaluate ways of transferring resources to reduce poverty in LICs on a 4-point Likert scale, the most preferred option in every country is "Cash transfers to parents (child allowances), to the disabled and to the elderly", with 16% selecting it as the *Best way* overall, and 49% as a *Right way* or *Best way* (Figures 13, **??**-**??**).[43] "Unconditional transfers to the national government" is the only option seen as a *Wrong way* by ~~the~~ a majority, but this share falls from 51% ~~down~~ to 21% (becoming the third most supported option out of seven) when "transfers to the national government [are] conditioned on the use of funds for poverty reduction programs". Interestingly, "unconditional cash transfers to each household" are controversial: they are the second most chosen *Best way*, yet 33% view them as a *Wrong way*. Conversely, "transfers to public development aid agencies which then finance suitable projects" is uncontroversial, with only 16% considering it a *Wrong way*, while 37% rate it as a *Right* or *Best way*.

VI.D Custom Global Income Redistribution

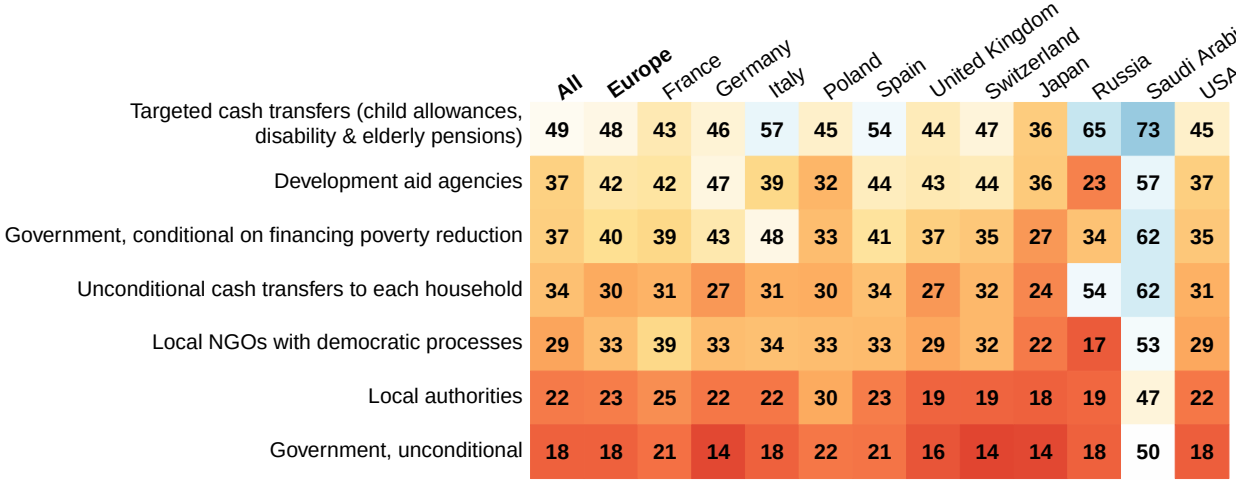
The last task of the questionnaire allowed respondents to manipulate the shape of the global income distribution.[44] The question text included the following instructions:

> "Below you will find a graph of the world distribution of after-tax income and three sliders that vary it. The current distribution is in red, and your custom one is in green. The first two sliders control the proportion of winners and the

[43] Admittedly, it would be more relevant to ask this question to the population of LICs. Carson et al. (2025) survey seven Global South countries and find that people favor using carbon tax revenues for public services rather than cash transfers.

[44] Appendix **??** details how I obtained the world distribution of PPP incomes.

Figure 13: "How do you evaluate each of these channels to transfer resources to reduce poverty in LICs?"
Percentage of *Right* or *Best way* (other options: *Wrong* or *Acceptable way*). (Question **??**).



	All	Europe	France	Germany	Italy	Poland	Spain	United Kingdom	Switzerland	Japan	Russia	Saudi Arabia	USA
Targeted cash transfers (child allowances, disability & elderly pensions)	49	48	43	46	57	45	54	44	47	36	65	73	45
Development aid agencies	37	42	42	47	39	32	44	43	44	36	23	57	37
Government, conditional on financing poverty reduction	37	40	39	43	48	33	41	37	35	27	34	62	35
Unconditional cash transfers to each household	34	30	31	27	31	30	34	27	32	24	54	62	31
Local NGOs with democratic processes	29	33	39	33	34	33	33	29	32	22	17	53	29
Local authorities	22	23	25	22	22	30	23	19	19	18	19	47	22
Government, unconditional	18	18	21	14	18	22	21	16	14	14	18	50	18

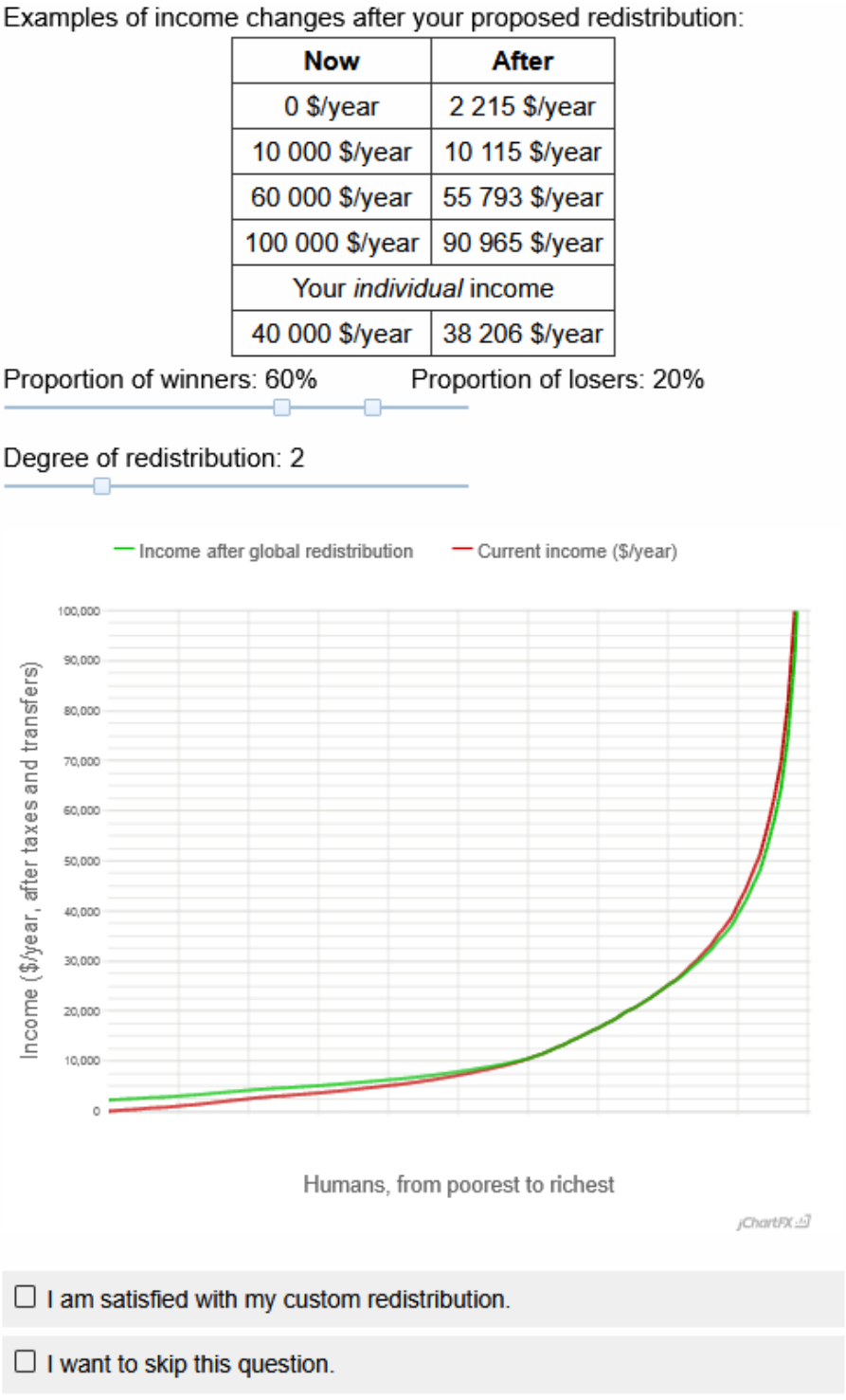
proportion of losers, among all humans. The third slider controls the degree of redistribution from the richest to the poorest. If you do not want new policies to reduce global inequality, you can set the third slider to zero."

The ~~interactive question is available at bit.ly/custom_global_redistr, an explainer video at youtu.be/gSfsQwczT7w, and the~~ algorithm translating slider positions into a redistribution is described in Appendix **??**; links to the interactive question and to an explainer video are withheld for anonymized review. Figure 14 displays what respondents see below the instructions, including the interactive graph and a table summarizing how their custom redistribution would affect five example income levels (including their own, asked right before). To mitigate potential anchoring at the sliders' initial positions,[45] sliders are initialized in one of two random positions: either 60% of winners, 20% of losers, and a degree of redistribution of 2 out of 10 (as in Figure 14); or 40%, 10%, and 7/10, respectively. Given the complexity of the task and its inconvenience on mobile devices, respondents are given the explicit option to skip it.

Overall, 56% are satisfied with their custom redistribution and 43% skip it. Although the non-response rate may seem high, it is relatively evenly spread across the population. Indeed, the share of satisfied respondents is 52% for non-voters, 54% for center-

[45] To test for anchoring, I regress responses on the sliders' initial positions. I define the anchoring effect as the effect size relative to the difference between the initial positions of the two variants. It is always significant, at 36% for the share of winners, 57% for the share of losers, and 42% for the degree of redistribution. While anchoring plays a role, the responses converge to a middle point between the two anchors, indicating that the anchors themselves may have been defined by the ~~surveyor (myself)~~ researcher drifting away from a shared preference in opposite directions.

Figure 14: Custom global redistribution: screenshot of the bottom of the page. (Question **??**).



right or right-wing voters, 57% for far-right voters, and 61% for left-wing voters; while it ranges from 49% for people without a high-school diploma to 57% for those with a

post-secondary diploma. The limited heterogeneity in response rates across crucial sociodemographic groups suggests that the task enabled motivated respondents to make an informed choice regarding their preferred redistribution with little sacrifice in terms of sample representativeness.

Figure **??** shows the median preferred redistribution among satisfied respondents, i.e., the curve obtained by setting the sliders at their median preferred values: 49% of winners, 18% of losers, and a degree of redistribution of 5/10, resulting in a transfer of 5.4% of world income from rich to poor and in a minimum income of $287 per month. Interestingly, 48% choose to lose from their custom redistribution while only 9% choose to win; the median satisfied respondent selects parameters such that they neither win nor lose. Besides, 10% of satisfied respondents opt for the status quo, preserving the current income distribution. Finally, Figure **??** presents the average preferred redistribution among satisfied respondents, obtained by pointwise averaging custom curves. The average preferred redistribution transfers 5.4% of world income from the top 27% to the bottom 73% and entails a minimum income of $247 per month. As shown in Figure **??**, at the top of the distribution, the average preferred redistribution can be achieved with a 7% marginal income tax rate above $25,000 and a 16% rate above $40,000 per year (at Purchasing Power Parity).

The average (resp. median) preferred redistribution would reduce the world Gini index from .67 to .59 (resp. .58), the D9/D1 ratio from 42 to 11 (resp. 10), the top 10% share from 52% to 47%, and ~~they would~~ increase the bottom 50% share from 8% to 13%.

Figures **??**-**??** reveal limited heterogeneity in custom redistributions across countries. However, Figures **??**-**??** show greater variation at the individual level, though the bulk of respondents favor a custom redistribution implying transfers of 4% to 5% of world income and a minimum income of $150 to $350 per month.

Fabre (2022) applied the same method to uncover French preferences regarding national income redistribution and tested support for the median and average preferred redistributions on a separate sample. Excluding the 22% to 24% of people not responding, 51% of respondents accepted the average redistribution and 67% the median one.[46] In the context of a global redistribution, it would be interesting to test whether these results would replicate and whether a majority would accept the average or median redistribution described above.

[46] Fabre (2022) also tested a redistribution obtained from median parameters and a 5% lower aggregate income to account for adverse behavioral responses. This was accepted by 62% of French respondents.

VII Conclusion

Applying the theory of optimal taxation, Kopczuk, Slemrod and Yitzhaki (2005) show that the level of U.S. foreign aid could only be rationalized if the U.S. government placed a value 2,000 times higher on the welfare of an American than on that of a foreigner (although this ratio should be reduced by the proportion of foreign aid transfers diverted or wasted). ~~Our~~ These results contradict the notion that government action accurately reflects attitudes towards global redistribution, and are consistent with a conservative bias among legislators (Broockman and Skovron 2018; Gilens and Page 2014; Pilet et al. 2023). Indeed, a majority of respondents in high-income countries support a global tax on top incomes to finance poverty reduction in low-income countries. Additionally, over two-thirds of respondents accept a tax on the wealth of millionaires with 30% of the revenue financing LICs, even ~~in the case of~~ if only a few countries implement~~ing~~it. In every country, majorities accept an International Climate Scheme that is costly to them but beneficial to the poorest globally, showing that most people value climate action and poverty reduction.

The revenue allocation task sheds light on how much people value global versus domestic public goods. On average, respondents allocate 17.5% of the revenue from a hypothetical global wealth tax to sustainable development~~out of the five specified~~ , one of five spending categories. This indicates that people are neither selfless universalists, who would allocate all the revenue from this tax to the poorest countries, nor devoid of altruism ~~towards foreigners, as this would imply allocating~~ toward foreigners, who would allocate nothing to global spending. The custom redistribution task confirms that most people would actually prefer much greater global redistribution than currently exists, as the average respondent opts for a global minimum income of $247 per month, financed by transfers amounting to over 5% of world income.

An exploration of respondents' underlying values reveals that support for global redistribution primarily stems from a sense of duty and empathy towards the destitute. For some, this issue appears important enough to factor into their voting decision. Indeed, the likelihood that a political program is preferred increases if it includes a globally redistributive tax on millionaires and decreases if it includes cuts to foreign aid. Additionally, one-third of respondents report that they would be more likely to vote for a political party if it were part of a global movement for sustainable development, and a similar proportion state that they could themselves participate in such a movement.

These results raise the question of why so few policymakers campaign on sustainable development proposals. The lack of supply of such campaigns might stem from

pluralistic ignorance among policymakers and activists, consistent with the public's underestimation of support for a Global Climate Scheme. Alternatively, it could be due to a lack of demand from constituents. Indeed, global inequality is rarely a top-of-mind consideration. People's most frequent concerns relate to self-interested issues such as their purchasing power or health; articulated political demands generally refer to national issues such as public services; and the most salient international issues are climate change, wars, and the rise of the far right.

The low salience of global inequality may ~~manifest as~~ result in a lack of popular mobilization, ~~resulting in it being~~ making it a low priority for policymakers. ~~Combined with the necessary~~ Given the trade-off between global redistribution and their fellow citizens' purchasing power, policymakers may prioritize the latter ~~—which is~~ (the primary concern of ~~voters—~~ voters) to the point of ignoring universalist attitudes. Status quo bias is a compounding factor: the weakness of global institutions and the primacy of national polities make international cooperation unlikely, which may discourage universalist thought and make it seem utopian. Indeed, support for global policies is partly caused by the belief that they are possible, as ~~our information experiment demonstrated~~the information experiment shows. Therefore, ~~the organization of the~~ a world order ~~based on~~ organized around nation-states might silence demands for universalist reforms and perpetuate a cycle ~~where~~ in which the low salience of universalist concerns and status quo institutions reinforce each other.

Nevertheless, the survey results suggest some untapped potential for global solidarity. In light of these findings, it is unlikely that the public would resist global redistribution policies. This is especially true for ~~balance sheet~~ balance-sheet operations with expansionary impacts and indirect costs, such as debt restructuring, liquidity provision, the expansion of lending by Multilateral Development Banks, and their recapitalization through the rechanneling of Special Drawing Rights. These reforms are widely accepted and are the natural focus of multilateral initiatives (Bridgetown Initiative 2025; FfD4 2025). Since public attitudes do not appear to be a limiting factor, further research is needed to understand policymakers' motivations and the obstacles they face in cooperating on sustainable development reforms.

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